

Min Aṭyab al-Minah fī ‘Ilm al-Muṣṭalaḥ

[Among the Sweetest of Gifts in the Science of Ḥadīth Terminology]

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Imam ‘Abd Allāh ibn al-Mubārak said: "The isnād (chain of transmission) is part of the religion; were it not for the isnād, whoever wished would say whatever he wished."

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Distributed free of charge

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In the name of Allah, the Most Merciful, the Bestower of Mercy

[p. 3] Khuṭbat al-Kitāb — The Author's Preface

In the name of Allah, the Most Merciful, the Bestower of Mercy

Praise be to Allah, Lord of the worlds, and prayers and peace be upon the master of the prophets and messengers, our Prophet Muḥammad, and upon his family and his Companions, and upon whoever follows him and is guided by his guidance until the Day of Recompense.

To proceed: this is a treatise on the science of terminology, in accordance with the curriculum prescribed in the secondary institute affiliated to the Islamic University in Madinah al-Munawwarah.

We have drawn it from the books of the leading authorities in this field, who define in them every one of the categories of ḥadīth, in an easy style and a clear mode of expression.

It has come out - and praise be to Allah - comprising the essentials of the discipline, with an abridgement that does not impair and without wearisome length.

We have named it *Min Aṭyab al-Minah fī 'Ilm al-Muṣṭalah*.

We ask Allah, glorified be He, to benefit the students of knowledge by it, for He is capable of all things, and worthy of answering.

The two authors

[p. 4] Muqaddimah fī Tārīkh 'Ilm al-Muṣṭalah wa-Nash'atihi — Introduction: The History of the Science of Terminology and Its Origins

The Islamic sciences had been committed to writing, and along with them was recorded the science of the terminology of ḥadīth and its foundational principles; except that this recording was scattered across various categories, in the midst of books of knowledge such as *al-Risālah* and *al-Umm*, both of them by Imam al-Shāfi'ī, may Allah the Exalted have mercy on him, and the introduction to *Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim*, and the end of the *Jāmi'* of al-Tirmidhī.

Then, when the fourth century of the Hijrah came - and in it the sciences and the disciplines ripened and technical terminology settled - the Qāḍī Abū Muḥammad al-Ḥasan ibn 'Abd al-Raḥmān ibn Khallād al-Rāmahurmuzī, who died in the year 360 AH, devoted a work to the discipline of terminology, the composition being in an initial state, in his book *al-Muḥaddith al-Fāṣil bayna al-Rāwī wa-l-Wāṭ'* [The Ḥadīth Scholar Who Distinguishes the Transmitter from the Retainer].

Then the scholars expanded upon it: Abū 'Abd Allāh al-Ḥākim al-Naysābūrī, who died in the year 405 AH, came and composed on it *Ma'rifat 'Ulūm al-Ḥadīth* [Knowledge of the Sciences of Ḥadīth], but he did not refine it nor exhaust it.

Then Abū Nu'aym Aḥmad ibn 'Abd Allāh al-Aṣbahānī, who died in the year 430 AH, came and produced a *mustakhraj* upon the book of al-Ḥākim, and left over matters for the one who would follow up.

Then al-Khaṭīb Abū Bakr Aḥmad ibn 'Alī al-Baghdādī, who died in the year 463 AH, came and composed on the rules of transmission *al-Kifāyah* [The Sufficiency], and on its etiquette *al-Jāmi' li-Ādāb al-Shaykh wa-l-Sāmi'* [The Compendium on the Etiquette of the Teacher and the Listener], and separate works on most of the branches of ḥadīth; and everyone who came after al-Khaṭīb became dependent upon his books, as al-Ḥāfiẓ Abū Bakr ibn Nuqṭah said.

Then the Qāḍī 'Iyāḍ, who died in the year 544 AH, came and compiled on that *al-Ilmā' fī Ḍabṭ al-Riwāyah wa-Taḥyīd al-Samā'* [Guidance on Precision in Transmission and the Recording of Audition].

Then Abū Ḥafṣ 'Umar al-Mayānājī, who died in the year 580 AH, composed a monograph he named *Mā lā Yasa'u al-Muḥaddith Jahluhu* [What the Ḥadīth Scholar Cannot Afford to Be Ignorant Of].

And after these and others came al-Ḥāfiẓ

Abū ‘Amr ‘Uthmān ibn ‘Abd al-Raḥmān, known as Ibn al-Ṣalāḥ, resident of Damascus, who died in the year 643 AH.

He compiled, when he was appointed to teach ḥadīth in the Ashrafiyyah school known as *Dār al-Ḥadīth*, his book *‘Ulūm al-Ḥadīth*, known as *Muqaddimat Ibn al-Ṣalāḥ*.

He refined its branches and dictated it piece by piece, and gave attention to the scattered compositions of al-Khaṭīb, gathered together their dispersed aims, and joined to them choice selections of their benefits from other sources.

So there gathered in his book what is scattered in others.

For this reason the scholars devoted themselves to it and followed its path: among them is he who abridged it, such as al-Nawawī in his *Irshād* and al-Bulqīnī in his *Maḥāsīn*; among them is he who versified it, such as al-‘Irāqī in his *Alfiyyah*; and among them is the one who supplemented it and the one who opposed it.

Among the most beneficial of the abridged books is: *Nukhbat al-Fikar fī Muṣṭalah al-Athar* [The Choicest of Ideas on the Terminology of Reports], by al-Ḥāfiẓ Ibn Ḥajar, who died in the year 852 AH.

Many have written commentaries upon it, among them al-Ḥāfiẓ himself, and his son Muḥammad ibn Aḥmad ibn Ḥajar, and ‘Abd al-Ra’ūf al-Munāwī, and Muḥammad Ṣādiq ibn ‘Abd al-Hādī al-Sindī.

Likewise a group versified the *Nukhbat*, among them Shihāb al-Dīn Aḥmad al-Ṭūfī, who died in the year 883 AH, and Muḥammad ibn Ismā‘īl al-Amīr al-Ṣan‘ānī, who died in the year 1182 AH.

Among the briefest of the abridgements is: *al-Manẓūmah al-Bayqūniyyah* [The Bayqūnī Poem], by Shaykh ‘Umar ibn Muḥammad ibn Futūḥ al-Bayqūnī al-Dimashqī.

Among those who commented upon it is the Nawwāb Ṣiddīq Ḥasan Khān, who died in the year 1307 AH, and he named it *al-‘Urjūn fī Sharḥ al-Bayqūn* [The Palm-Branch: A Commentary on al-Bayqūn].

Among the carefully edited books are *Tadrīb al-Rāwī Sharḥ Taqrīb al-Nawāwī* [The Training of the Transmitter: A Commentary on al-Nawawī's *Taqrīb*] by al-Suyūṭī; *Fath al-Mughīth Sharḥ al-Alfiyyah* [The Opening Granted by the Helper: A Commentary on the *Alfiyyah*] by al-Sakhāwī; *Tawḍīḥ al-Afkār Sharḥ Tanqīḥ al-Anzār* [The Clarification of Ideas: A Commentary on *Tanqīḥ al-Anzār*] by al-Ṣan‘ānī; and *Qawā‘id al-Taḥdīth* [The Rules of Ḥadīth Transmission] by Jamāl al-Dīn al-Qāsimī; and *Tawjīh al-Nazar* [The Directing of the Gaze] by al-Jazā‘irī.

May Allah reward them all with the best of reward.

[p. 6] Muṣṭalah al-Ḥadīth wa-Mawḍū‘uhu wa-Thamratuhu — The Terminology of Ḥadīth, Its Subject Matter and Its Purpose

Definition: It is a science of foundational principles and rules by which the states of the isnād and the matn (text of the report) are known, with respect to acceptance and rejection.

Its subject matter: The isnād and the matn, with respect to acceptance and rejection.

Its purpose and aim: Distinguishing the ṣaḥīḥ (authentic) from the unsound among the ḥadīths.

Al-Ḥadīth wa-l-Khabar wa-l-Athar wa-l-Ṣṭilāḥāt Ukhrā — Ḥadīth, Report, Athar, and Other Technical Terms

Al-Ḥadīth: Lexically, the new; and it is pluralised as *aḥādīth*, contrary to analogy.

Technically, it is what is ascribed to the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, of a statement, an act, a tacit approval, a physical description, or a description of character.

Al-Khabar (the report): Lexically, the piece of news.

Technically, it is said to be synonymous with ḥadīth; and it is said that the two are distinct: ḥadīth is what comes from the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, and the report is what comes from someone other than him.

And it is said that between the two there is absolute generality and particularity: ḥadīth is what comes from the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, while the report is what comes from him or from someone other than him.

Al-Athar: Lexically, the remainder of a thing.

Technically: what is transmitted from the Companions and the Successors, of statements or acts.

And it is said that athar is synonymous with ḥadīth.

Al-Ḥadīth al-Qudsī: It is what is conveyed from the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, together with his ascribing it to his Lord, Mighty and Majestic.

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The difference between the ḥadīth qudsī and the Qur'ān is that the Qur'ān is inimitable in its wording, is an act of worship in its recitation, and mutawātir transmission is a condition for establishing it.

The ḥadīth qudsī is not described as inimitable, is not an act of worship in its recitation, and mutawātir transmission is not a condition for its being established.

The qudsī ḥadīths are more than one hundred ḥadīths; among them is what Muslim transmitted in his *Ṣaḥīḥ* from Abū Dharr, may Allah be pleased with him, from the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, in what he transmits from Allah the Exalted, that He said: "O My servants, I have forbidden oppression to Myself and have made it forbidden among you, so do not oppress one another." - the ḥadīth.

Its transmission has two forms:

1. The Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, said, in what he transmits from his Lord, Mighty and Majestic.
2. Allah the Exalted said, in what His Messenger, peace and blessings be upon him, transmitted from Him.

And the meaning is one.

Al-Sanad: with a faṭḥah on the nūn; lexically, that which is relied upon.

Technically: the chain of men that leads to the matn.

Al-Matn: with a sukūn; lexically, what is hard and raised up from the ground.

And technically: that speech at which the isnād terminates.

It was named thus because the *musnad* strengthens the ḥadīth by its isnād and raises it to the one who said it.

Al-Isnād - it has two meanings:

1. Attributing the ḥadīth to the one who said it, with a chain of transmission.

2. The chain of men that leads to the matn; and upon this it is synonymous with al-sanad.
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Al-Musnad: with a fathah on the nūn, it has two meanings:

1. Every book in which the transmissions of one Companion or more are gathered, each separately, such as the *Musnad* of Imam Aḥmad, may Allah have mercy on him, and the *Musnad* of ‘Abd Allāh ibn ‘Umar by Muḥammad ibn Ibrāhīm al-Ṭarsūsī.
2. The marfū‘ ḥadīth whose isnād is connected.

Al-Musnid, with a kasrah on the nūn: he is the one who transmits the ḥadīth with its isnād, whether he has knowledge of it or has no more than the bare transmission.

Al-Muḥaddith: he is the one who occupies himself with the science of ḥadīth, in transmission and in comprehension, and who has acquaintance with a great many of the transmitted reports and the states of their narrators.

Al-Ḥāfiẓ: it is synonymous with al-muḥaddith in the usage of many of the ḥadīth scholars; and it is said that al-ḥāfiẓ is of a higher rank than al-muḥaddith, such that what he knows of every generation is more than what he is ignorant of.

Taqṣīm al-Khabar ilā Mutawātir wa-Āḥād — The Division of the Report into Mutawātir and Āḥād

The report is divided, with respect to the manner of its reaching us, into mutawātir and āḥād.

Al-Khabar al-Mutawātir — The Mutawātir Report

Mutawātir is derived from *al-tawātur*, which is successive following-on.

Technically, it is what a number transmitted so large that custom makes it inconceivable that they colluded and agreed upon a falsehood.

Taqṣīm al-Khabar al-Mutawātir — The Division of the Mutawātir Report

The mutawātir report is of two kinds: verbal (*lafẓī*) and by meaning (*ma‘nawī*).

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1. **Al-Mutawātir al-Lafẓī (verbal mutawātir):** it is what is transmitted by mutawātir transmission both in its wording and in its meaning.
Its example is the ḥadīth: "Whoever lies against me deliberately, let him take his seat in the Fire."
Some seventy-odd Companions transmitted it.

Al-Mutawātir al-Ma‘nawī (mutawātir by meaning): it is what is transmitted by mutawātir transmission in its meaning but not in its wording.

Its examples are many; among them: the ḥadīth of wiping over the leather socks, and the ḥadīth of the punishment of the grave.

Shurūṭ al-Mutawātir — The Conditions of the Mutawātir

The conditions of the mutawātir are four, and they are:

1. That a large number transmit it.
2. That this number be found in all the levels of the isnād.
3. That custom make it inconceivable that they colluded and agreed upon a falsehood.
4. That the basis of their report be sense-perception.

This being so, the relied-upon position is that the mutawātir report yields necessary knowledge, which is that to which a person is compelled such that he cannot repel it.

And it is said: it yields nothing but theoretical knowledge; but this is nothing, because knowledge by way of mutawātir transmission is obtained by one who has no competence for theoretical reasoning, such as the ordinary person.

Akḥbār al-Āḥād — The Āḥād Reports

Al-Āḥād: it is the plural of *aḥad*, with the meaning of "one".

And *ḥabār al-wāḥid* (the report of a single narrator) is, lexically, what a single person transmitted.

Technically it is: that in which the conditions of the mutawātir are not fulfilled.

It yields probable knowledge; and it is said that it yields certain knowledge.

As for acting upon it, that is definitively obligatory.

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Ibn Ḥazm, may Allah the Exalted have mercy on him, said: The report of a single upright narrator from one like him, back to the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, necessitates both knowledge and action together.

Taqṣīm al-Āḥād — The Division of the Āḥād

The report of a single narrator is divided into: mashhūr, ‘azīz, and gharīb.

1. **Al-Khabar al-Mashhūr:** lexically, what has become widely known upon the tongues, even if it be a lie.

Such as the ḥadīth: "Love of one's homeland is part of faith"; and the ḥadīth: "The day of your fasting is the day of your sacrifice."

Technically it is: what three or more transmitted, but which did not reach the limit of mutawātir transmission.

It was named thus because of its being widely known and evident; and some of them call it *al-mustafīḍ*.

And it is said that the mustafīḍ is more specific than the mashhūr, since it is stipulated in it that the two ends of its isnād be equal in number.

Among its examples is the ḥadīth: "Whoever points the way to good has the like of the reward of the one who does it." Muslim transmitted it.

And the ḥadīth: "Haste is from Satan." Al-Tirmidhī graded it ḥasan (sound).

2. **Al-Khabar al-ʿAzīz:** it is what two transmit, even if in only one of its levels.

Its example is what the two Shaykhs [al-Bukhārī and Muslim] transmitted from Anas, may Allah be pleased with him, and what al-Bukhārī transmitted from Abū Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, said: "None of you believes until I am more beloved to him than his father and his child."

It was named ʿazīz either because of its strength - since it came by another route - or because of its scarcity and rarity.

From ʿazza yaʿizzu, with a kasrah on the ʿayn in the imperfect, ʿizzan and ʿizzatan and ʿazāzatan, both with a kasrah: he became ʿazīz, that is, strong; and *the thing was scarce*, so it is scarcely to be found.

This being so, it is not a condition for the authenticity of a ḥadīth that it be ʿazīz, according to the majority,

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contrary to the one who claimed that, such as Abū ʿAlī al-Jubbāʾī, and Ibn al-ʿArabī, and al-Ḥākim. Al-Ṣanʿānī said in his versification of the *Nukhbah*:

And it is not a condition for the ṣaḥīḥ, so know;
and it is said that it is a condition - and that is the statement of al-Ḥākim.

3. **Al-Khabar al-Gharīb:** it is also called *al-fard*, and it is what a single narrator transmitted.

Its example is the ḥadīth: "Actions are only by intentions."

For Yaḥyā ibn Saʿīd al-Anṣārī was alone in transmitting it from Muḥammad ibn Ibrāhīm al-Taymī, from ʿAlqamah ibn Waqqāṣ al-Laythī, from ʿUmar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb, may Allah be pleased with him; then a great many people transmitted it from al-Anṣārī.

Taqṣīm al-Khabar al-Gharīb — The Division of the Gharīb Report

The gharīb is divided into absolute (*muṭlaq*) and relative (*nisbī*).

1. **Al-Gharīb al-Muṭlaq (the absolutely gharīb):** it is also called *al-fard al-muṭlaq*, and it is: that in which the singularity and the being-alone occurs at the root of its isnād, which is the end nearest the Companion - as when a single Successor is alone in transmitting it from a Companion and is not corroborated in it.

Its example is: the ḥadīth of the prohibition of selling the right of clientage (*al-walāʾ*) and of giving it away; ʿAbd Allāh ibn Dīnār was alone in transmitting it from ʿAbd Allāh ibn ʿUmar, may Allah be pleased with them both; Mālik transmitted it in the *Muwattaʾ*.

The singularity may continue through all the men of the isnād, or through most of them.

Among the places where it is to be found are the *Musnad* of al-Bazzār and *al-Muʿjam al-Awsaṭ* of al-Ṭabarānī.

2. **Al-Gharīb al-Nisbī (the relatively gharīb):** it is also called *al-fard al-nisbī*, and it is: that in which the singularity and the being-alone occurs in the middle of its isnād - as when a follower of the Successor

is alone in transmitting it, or someone below him among the men.

It was named thus because the singularity occurring in it is relative to a particular person; and the ḥadīth may well be mashhūr.

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Its example is: the ḥadīth of Mālik from al-Zuhrī, from Anas, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, entered Makkah with a helmet on his head; the two Shaykhs transmitted it.

Al-Ḥāfiẓ said: Applying the term *al-fard* to the relative is uncommon; most often *al-fard* is applied to the absolute, just as *al-gharīb* is applied to the relative in abundance.

Taqṣīm al-Āḥād ilā Maqbūl wa-Mardūd — The Division of the Āḥād into Accepted and Rejected

The āḥād - that is, the mashhūr, the ‘azīz, and the gharīb - are divided into accepted (*maqbūl*) and rejected (*mardūd*).

Al-Khabar al-Maqbūl wa-Ḥukmuḥu — The Accepted Report and Its Ruling

Al-Khabar al-Maqbūl: it is that by which one argues as proof.

There is disagreement over its ruling. That which the scholars from among the Companions and the Successors, and those after them among the ḥadīth scholars and the jurists, hold is that the report of a single trustworthy (thiqah) narrator is a proof from among the proofs of the Sacred Law, by which action is obligatory.

Khabar al-Wāḥid al-Muḥtaff bi-l-Qarā’in wa-Anwā’uḥu — The Single-Narrator Report Attended by Corroborating Indications, and Its Kinds

There is no doubt that the single-narrator report attended by corroborating indications is stronger than that which is devoid of them; and it is of kinds, among them the following:

1. What the two Shaykhs, al-Bukhārī and Muslim, brought out in their two *Ṣaḥīḥs*, of that which does not reach the limit of mutawātir transmission.
For there attend it, among the corroborating indications, the eminence of the two Shaykhs in this field, their precedence over others in distinguishing the authentic from the unsound, and the scholars' receiving their two books with acceptance.
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2. The report that comes down through a chain successively composed of the leading, exacting ḥāfiẓ authorities, where it is not gharīb - such as a ḥadīth transmitted by Imam Aḥmad, who is not alone in it, from Imam al-Shāfi‘ī, and al-Shāfi‘ī transmits it likewise from Imam Mālik, and Mālik transmits it

from Nāfi', for example.

3. **Al-Khabar al-Mashhūr**: that which has various routes, all of them free of weakness in the narrators and free of hidden defects.

These kinds - knowledge is not obtained by them except for the scholar deeply versed in the science of ḥadīth, who is acquainted with the states of the narrators and with hidden defects.

Taqṣīm al-Khabar al-Maqbūl ilā Ṣaḥīḥ wa-Ḥasan — The Division of the Accepted Report into Ṣaḥīḥ and Ḥasan

The accepted report is divided, with respect to the disparity of its ranks, into: ṣaḥīḥ in itself (*li-dhātihi*), ḥasan in itself, ṣaḥīḥ by virtue of something else (*li-ghayrihi*), and ḥasan by virtue of something else.

Al-Ṣaḥīḥ li-Dhātihi — The Ṣaḥīḥ in Itself

Al-Ṣaḥīḥ li-dhātihi: it is what a narrator of integrity and complete precision conveyed from one like him, with a connected isnād, without a hidden defect and without irregularity.

Explanation of the definition:

Al-'Adl (the narrator of integrity): he is the Muslim, of sound mind, who has reached maturity, who is free of open sinfulness through committing a major sin or persisting in a minor one, and who is likewise free of what impairs personal propriety (*al-murū'ah*).

Excluded by the restriction "of integrity" are: the liar, the one accused of lying, the openly sinful, the innovator, and the unknown narrator.

Al-Ḍabṭ (precision): it is firmness in retention, and it is of two kinds:

1. **Precision of the breast (ḍabṭ ṣadr)**, which is: that the narrator establishes firmly in his breast what he heard,

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such that he is able to bring it to mind whenever he wishes.

2. **Precision of the book (ḍabṭ kitāb)**, which is: that the narrator guards his book and preserves it with him from the time he heard in it and corrected it, until he transmits from it.

Excluded by the restriction "complete precision" are: the one prone to delusion, the one whose error is gross, the one much given to heedlessness, the one who contradicts the trustworthy narrators, the one of poor retention, and the one of slight precision.

Guarded against by "with a connected isnād" is that whose isnād is not connected, such as the mu'allaq and the like.

Excluded by the restriction "**without a hidden defect and without irregularity**" are: the mu'allal (defective) report and the shādh report.

Al-Mu‘allal: lexically, that in which there is a defect. Technically, that in which there is a hidden defect that impugns the authenticity of the report, even though outwardly it appears free of it.

Al-Shādhḍh: lexically, the one that stands apart. Technically: that in which the narrator contradicts one who is more to be preferred than he. It has another interpretation which will come later.

Marātib al-Ṣaḥīḥ — The Ranks of the Ṣaḥīḥ

The ranks of the ṣaḥīḥ differ on account of the disparity of the qualities that require authenticity.

So that whose narrators are of the highest degree of integrity and precision, and of the remaining qualities that require preference, is more authentic than what is below it.

Of the highest rank is what some of the leading authorities have declared to be the most authentic of the isnāds, such as Mālik from Nāfi‘ from Ibn ‘Umar, may Allah be pleased with them both; and such as Ibrāhīm from ‘Alqamah from Ibn Mas‘ūd, may Allah be pleased with him.

Below that in rank is the transmission of Ḥammād ibn Salamah from Thābit from Anas, may Allah be pleased with them both.

And below that in rank is the transmission of Suhayl ibn Abī Ṣāliḥ from his father from Abū Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him.

Attached to this ranking is the division of the ṣaḥīḥ into seven categories, which are:

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- 1 - What the two Shaykhs, al-Bukhārī and Muslim, agreed upon.
- 2 - What al-Bukhārī alone transmitted.
- 3 - What Muslim alone transmitted.
- 4 - What was upon the condition of both of them, but which they did not bring out.
- 5 - What was upon the condition of al-Bukhārī.
- 6 - What was upon the condition of Muslim.
- 7 - What was authentic in the estimation of leading authorities other than the two of them, such as Ibn Khuzaymah and Ibn Ḥibbān, of what was not upon the condition of the two of them.

Sharṭ al-Shaykhayn — The Condition of the Two Shaykhs

It has not been transmitted from the two Shaykhs, al-Bukhārī and Muslim, that they stipulated a condition and specified it.

Rather, the researching scholars followed the traces of their methods and their procedure until there was obtained for them what they supposed to be conditions on the part of the two; and for this reason they differed over it.

We mention here what al-Nawawī said, and what al-Ḥāfiẓ approved in the *Nukhbah*, which is:

What is meant by "the condition of the two Shaykhs, or of one of them" is: that the ḥadīth be transmitted by way of the men of the two books, or of one of them, together with regard for the manner which the two Shaykhs bound themselves to in transmitting from them.

Al-Ḥasan li-Dhātihi — The Ḥasan in Itself

Al-Ḥasan li-dhātihi: it is what a narrator of integrity whose precision is light transmitted, with a connected isnād, without a hidden defect and without irregularity.

So it gathers the conditions of the ṣaḥīḥ in itself, except that precision is light in some of its narrators; and it shares with the ṣaḥīḥ also in being argued with as proof.

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The ḥasan has ranks like the ranks of the ṣaḥīḥ.

Al-Ḥāfiẓ al-Dhahabī said: The highest of the ranks of the ḥasan is the ḥadīth of Bahz ibn Ḥakīm from his father from his grandfather; and ‘Amr ibn Shu‘ayb from his father from his grandfather.

Al-Ṣaḥīḥ li-Ghayrihi — The Ṣaḥīḥ by Virtue of Something Else

Al-Ṣaḥīḥ li-ghayrihi: it is the ḥasan in itself when its routes are multiple; for by that it is strengthened and rises from the degree of the ḥasan to the degree of the ṣaḥīḥ - but not in itself, rather by virtue of something else.

An example of that: the ḥadīth of Muḥammad ibn ‘Amr ibn ‘Alqamah, from Abū Salamah, from Abū Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, said: "Were it not that it would be burdensome upon my community, I would have commanded them to use the tooth-stick at every prayer."

Al-Tirmidhī said, after bringing out the ḥadīth: And the ḥadīth of Abū Hurayrah is only authentic because it has been transmitted by more than one route.

This being so, let it be known that the exemplification is not for the ḥadīth absolutely, but restricted to its being of the transmission of Muḥammad ibn ‘Amr; otherwise the ḥadīth was transmitted by the two Shaykhs by other than his route.

Ibn al-Ṣalāḥ said: Muḥammad ibn ‘Amr ibn ‘Alqamah is among those well known for truthfulness and integrity, but he was not among the people of exactitude, so that some of them declared him weak from the standpoint of his poor retention, while some of them declared him trustworthy on account of his truthfulness and integrity; so his ḥadīth is ḥasan from this standpoint.

Al-Ḥasan li-Ghayrihi — The Ḥasan by Virtue of Something Else

The ḥasan by virtue of something else is the report whose acceptance is suspended, such as the transmission of the *mastūr* (the outwardly upright but inwardly unexamined narrator) and the like, when it is corroborated by the like of it or by something stronger than it.

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Its origin is weak, and the ḥasan character only came upon it through what strengthened it by way of the corroborating chain (*mutāba‘ah*).

An example of that is the ḥadīth of Abū Sa‘īd al-Khudrī, may Allah be pleased with him: "There shall be no harm and no reciprocating of harm." Al-Dāraquṭnī and al-Ḥākim transmitted it.

For the ḥadīth has routes not one of which is free of some criticism, but they strengthen one another; and for this reason al-Nawawī and Ibn al-Ṣalāḥ graded it ḥasan.

Qawl al-Tirmidhī wa-Ghayrihi: "Ḥadīth Ḥasan Ṣaḥīḥ" — The Statement of al-Tirmidhī and Others: "A Ḥadīth That Is Ḥasan and Ṣaḥīḥ"

The mentioned expression may be found problematic, because the ḥasan falls short of the degree of the ṣaḥīḥ; so how can the affirmation of falling short and its negation be combined in a single ḥadīth?

Al-Ḥāfiẓ answered that by saying: the ḥadīth to which the two descriptions, ḥasan and authenticity, are applied together cannot but be one of two cases: either it is gharīb, a single narrator being alone in it, or it is not.

Upon the first supposition, the reason for combining the two descriptions is that leading authority's hesitation regarding the one who was alone in it - as to whether he was precise, so that his ḥadīth is ṣaḥīḥ, or was of light precision, so that his ḥadīth is ḥasan.

The sense of the expression is: "ḥasan or ṣaḥīḥ", and it is below what is said of decisively: "ṣaḥīḥ".

Upon the second supposition - which is that the ḥadīth is not a solitary one - that combining is by consideration of two isnāds: one of them ṣaḥīḥ and the other ḥasan.

So the two descriptions are applied to it by consideration of its two isnāds; and it is stronger than what is said of: "ṣaḥīḥ" only.

An example of that is the ḥadīth: "Were it not that it would be burdensome upon my community, I would have commanded them to use the tooth-stick at every prayer."

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The two Shaykhs transmitted it by an authentic route, and al-Tirmidhī also brought it out by the route of the aforementioned Muḥammad ibn 'Amr, who is disputed over as to grading his ḥadīth ṣaḥīḥ or ḥasan; so al-Tirmidhī applied to it the ḥasan and authenticity together.

Al-Ḥāfiẓ Ibn Daqīq al-ʿĪd said: There is no incompatibility between the ḥasan and authenticity, except where the description of ḥasan stands alone.

As for when the ḥadīth reaches the degree of authenticity, the ḥasan is inevitably obtained as a consequence of the authenticity, because the presence of the higher degree does not negate the presence of the lower.

So it is correct to say: ḥasan by consideration of the lower quality, and ṣaḥīḥ by consideration of the higher quality.

Qawl al-Tirmidhī: "Ḥasan Gharīb" — The Statement of al-Tirmidhī: "Ḥasan and Gharīb"

Some of them criticised Imam al-Tirmidhī for combining the ḥasan and the gharīb, since the ḥasan in his usage is what is transmitted by more than one route, while the gharīb is what a single narrator was alone in transmitting.

Al-Ḥāfiẓ Ibn Ḥajar answered, the summary of which is: this technical usage of al-Tirmidhī's is to be established and applied to every ḥadīth that he described as ḥasan only.

As for what he described with the ḥasan and the gharīb together, what is meant by the ḥasan is according to the technical usage of the majority; and there is no incompatibility between the ḥasan and the gharīb upon their technical usage.

And Shaykh Ibn Taymiyyah, may Allah have mercy on him, said: Those who impugned al-Tirmidhī did not understand his intent in much of what he said; for the people of ḥadīth may say: "This ḥadīth is gharīb", that is, from this route - and they may state that explicitly.

So the ḥadīth may be, in their estimation, authentic and well known by one route; and when it is transmitted by another route it is gharīb from that route, even though the matn be authentic and well known.

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So when al-Tirmidhī says: "ḥasan gharīb", he may mean by that that it is gharīb from that route, but the matn has supporting narrations (shawāhid) by which it came to be counted among the ḥasan.

Ziyādat al-Thiqah wa-Taqsīm al-Khabar ilā Maḥfūẓ wa-Shādhdh — The Addition of the Trustworthy Narrator, and the Division of the Report into Maḥfūẓ and Shādhdh

Among the categories of the sciences of ḥadīth to which attention should properly be given are the additions of the trustworthy narrators.

The addition, just as it occurs in the matn, occurs also in the isnād - by raising a mawqūf report, or connecting a disconnected one, or the like of that.

Shaykh Ibn al-Ṣalāḥ divided the addition into three categories, and al-Nawawī and Ibn Ḥajar and others approved it; and they are:

1 - What the trustworthy narrator added in a manner incompatible with what the trustworthy narrators or the one more trustworthy than he transmitted: this, its ruling is rejection.

The transmission of the trustworthy narrators, or of the one more trustworthy, is called *al-maḥfūẓ*, and the transmission of the single trustworthy narrator is called *al-shādhdh*.

Therefore **al-Khabar al-Maḥfūẓ** is: what the trustworthy narrators, or the one more trustworthy, transmitted, incompatibly with what the [single] trustworthy narrator transmitted.

And al-Khabar al-Shādhdh is: what the trustworthy narrator transmitted contradicting what the trustworthy narrators, or the one more trustworthy than he, transmitted.

An example of that in the isnād is what al-Tirmidhī transmitted from the ḥadīth of Abū Saʿīd al-Khudrī, may Allah be pleased with him, as marfūʿ: "The whole earth is a place of prayer, except the graveyard and the bath-house."

Ḥammād ibn Salamah transmitted it as connected, from ʿAmr ibn Yaḥyā, from his father, from Abū Saʿīd, as marfūʿ; and Sufyān al-Thawrī transmitted it as mursal, from ʿAmr, from his father, from the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him - and al-Thawrī is more trustworthy than Ḥammād.

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And so al-Dāraqūṭnī said in *al-ʿIlal*: The maḥfūẓ is the mursal.

2 - What the trustworthy narrator added, not incompatible with the transmission of the trustworthy narrators or of the one more trustworthy than he: this, its ruling is acceptance, because it has the status of an independent report in which the trustworthy narrator was alone from his shaykh.

An example of that in the matn is what Muslim and al-Nasā'ī transmitted by the route of 'Alī ibn Mus'hir, from al-A'mash, from Abū Ṣāliḥ and Abū Razīn, from Abū Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, of the addition:

"then let him pour it out" - in the ḥadīth of the dog's lapping; and the rest of the ḥuffāḥ among the companions of al-A'mash did not mention it.

So this addition is like a report in which 'Alī ibn Mus'hir was alone, and he is trustworthy.

3 - What the trustworthy narrator added with a kind of incompatibility with the transmission of one who has more claim than he, except that this incompatibility is confined to the restricting of an unrestricted statement or the particularising of a general one: this, its ruling is acceptance, upon the preferred position.

An example of that in the matn is what Muslim and others transmitted by the route of Muḥammad ibn Sīrīn, from Abū Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, of the addition: "the first of them with earth" - in the ḥadīth of the lapping; whereas the transmission of the rest of the trustworthy narrators from Abū Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, is devoid of the addition of using earth; and this addition restricts the unrestricted character of the transmission of the other trustworthy narrators.

Al-Khabar al-Ma'rūf wa-l-Munkar — The Ma'rūf Report and the Munkar Report

Al-Khabar al-Ma'rūf: and opposite to it is the munkar. It is: what the trustworthy narrator transmitted, contradicting what the weak narrator transmitted.

And al-Khabar al-Munkar: it is what the weak narrator transmitted, contradicting the trustworthy narrator.

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An example of that is what Ibn Abī Ḥātim transmitted by the route of Ḥubayyib - in the diminutive - ibn Ḥabīb al-Zayyāt, and he is weak, from Abū Ishāq, from al-'Ayzār ibn Ḥurayth, from Ibn 'Abbās, may Allah be pleased with them both, as marfū': "Whoever establishes the prayers, and pays the zakāt dues, and performs the pilgrimage to the House, and fasts Ramaḍān, and shows hospitality to the guest, enters Paradise."

Abū Ḥātim said: It is munkar, because the trustworthy narrators transmitted it from Abū Ishāq, from al-'Ayzār, from Ibn 'Abbās, may Allah be pleased with them both, as mawqūf - and that is the ma'rūf.

Al-Mutāba'ah wa-Anwā'uhā — The Corroborating Chain and Its Kinds

Al-Mutāba'ah is, lexically, agreement. Technically it is: that participation with the narrator in the transmission is obtained. And it is of two kinds:

1 - **Al-Mutāba'ah al-Tāmmah (the complete corroborating chain):** it is that the participation is obtained with the narrator himself.

2 - **Al-Mutāba‘ah al-Qāṣirah (the deficient corroborating chain):** it is that the participation is obtained with the narrator's shaykh, or with whoever is above him among the narrators.

Al-Mutābi‘ wa-l-Shāhid wa-l-I‘tibār — The Corroborating Narration, the Supporting Narration, and Collation

Al-Mutābi‘, with a kasrah on the single-dotted bā’ - and it is also called *tābi‘* - is: the report that shares with the solitary one in wording and meaning, or in meaning only, together with unity in the Companion.

Al-Shāhid (the supporting narration): it is the report that shares with the solitary one in wording and meaning, or in meaning only, together with difference in the Companion.

Some of them specified the mutābi‘ as that which is obtained in wording, whether the Companion is the same or different; and the shāhid as that which is obtained in meaning, likewise.

And each of the mutābi‘ and the shāhid may be applied to the other.

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Al-I‘tibār (collation): it is following the traces of the routes of the solitary report, so as to know whether it has a mutābi‘ or a shāhid or not.

Al-Ḥāfiẓ gave as an example of that what Imam al-Shāfi‘ī transmitted in *al-Umm*, from Mālik, from ‘Abd Allāh ibn Dīnār, from ‘Abd Allāh ibn ‘Umar, may Allah be pleased with them both, who said: The Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, said: "The month is twenty-nine [days]; so do not fast until you see the crescent, and do not break the fast until you see it. And if it is obscured from you, then complete the count as thirty."

Some supposed that al-Shāfi‘ī was alone in the wording: "then complete the count as thirty", because the companions of Mālik other than al-Shāfi‘ī transmitted it with the wording: "then estimate it for it".

But there was found for al-Shāfi‘ī a corroborating chain both complete and deficient.

For Imam al-Bukhārī transmitted it in his *Ṣaḥīḥ*, from ‘Abd Allāh ibn Maslamah al-Qa‘nabī, from Mālik, with the very same isnād; so this is a complete corroborating chain of the utmost authenticity.

And Ibn Khuzaymah transmitted it in *al-Ṣaḥīḥ* by the route of ‘Āṣim ibn Muḥammad ibn Zayd, from his father, from his grandfather ‘Abd Allāh ibn ‘Umar, may Allah be pleased with them both, with the wording: "then complete thirty".

So this is a deficient corroborating chain.

And Muslim also transmitted it by the route of ‘Ubayd Allāh ibn ‘Umar, from Nāfi‘, from Ibn ‘Umar, may Allah be pleased with them both, with the wording: "then estimate thirty".

And it has a supporting narration in al-Nasā‘ī by the route of Muḥammad ibn Ḥunayn, from ‘Abd Allāh ibn ‘Abbās, may Allah be pleased with them both, from the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, the like of the ḥadīth of Ibn Dīnār from Ibn ‘Umar, may Allah be pleased with them both.

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Al-Muḥkam wa-Mukhtalif al-Ḥadīth — The Muḥkam and Conflicting Ḥadīth

Al-Khabar al-Muḥkam: it is the accepted report that is free of opposition by the like of it; and its ruling is that acting upon it is obligatory. Most reports are of this kind.

Mukhtalif al-Ḥadīth (conflicting ḥadīth): it is the accepted report that is opposed by the like of it, together with the possibility of reconciling the two.

Among those who composed on this kind are: Imam al-Shāfiʿī, and al-Ṭaḥāwī, and Ibn Qutaybah.

Mādhā Yurjaʿ ilayhi ʿinda Taʾāruḍ al-Khabarayn al-Maqbūlayn? — What Is Resorted to When Two Accepted Reports Conflict?

When two accepted reports conflict, and reconciling and harmonising the two is possible without forced contrivance and strained treatment, then one does not proceed to anything else.

An example of that: what the two Shaykhs transmitted from the ḥadīth: "Flee from the leper as you flee from the lion"; and what Mālik transmitted: "Let no sick one be brought in upon a healthy one" - together with the ḥadīth: "There is no contagion and no ill omen", which Muslim transmitted.

The outward appearance of this is conflict, since in the first he commanded fleeing, and in the last he negated contagion.

The mode of reconciliation is: that diseases do not transmit of their own nature, as the people of the pre-Islamic age and some of the physicians believed; but Allah, glorified be He, made the sick person's mixing with the healthy one a cause of transmitting his disease to him; and that may fail to follow from its cause, as in other causes.

If reconciling the two reports is not possible, resort is had to chronology; for if the later is known, it is the abrogating of the earlier, and it is acted upon.

And if the chronology is unknown and it is possible to give preference to one of the two reports by one of the modes of preference relating to the isnād or the matn, then the recourse is to preference.

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And if preference is not feasible, acting upon the two is suspended until the mode of preference becomes clear to the one who examines.

Al-Naskh wa-Mā Yuʿraf bihi — Abrogation and What It Is Known By

Al-Naskh (abrogation), lexically: removal and transferral. You say: *nasakhat al-shams al-ẓill* (the sun removed the shade) when it removed it; and *nasakhtu al-kitāb* (I copied the book) when you transferred something resembling what is in it.

And al-Naskh in the Sacred Law: the lifting of a legal ruling by a later legal proof.

Abrogation is known by a number of things, among them: an explicit text, and this is the plainest - such as the ḥadīth: "I used to forbid you from visiting the graves; so visit them." Muslim transmitted it.

And among them: what the Companion informed of as being later - such as the statement of Jābir, may Allah be pleased with him: "The last of the two matters from the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, was abandoning ablution from what fire has touched." Al-Tirmidhī transmitted it.

And among them: what is known by chronology.

As for what a Companion of later conversion to Islam transmitted, contradicting what a Companion who preceded him in Islam transmitted from him, that does not indicate abrogation, because of the possibility that he heard it from another Companion earlier than that earlier one, or that he heard it from one like himself and transmitted it as mursāl.

And consensus is not itself an abrogating agent, but rather it indicates abrogation.

[p. 25] As'ilah wa-Tamārīn — Questions and Exercises

1. Speak briefly about the origins of the terminology of ḥadīth; then define it, and explain its subject matter and its purpose; then mention the meanings of the following technical terms:

Al-Ḥadīth. Al-Khabar. Al-Athar. Al-Ḥadīth al-Qudsī. Al-Sanad. Al-Matn. Al-Isnād. Al-Musnad, with fatḥah and with kasrah. Al-Muḥaddith. Al-Ḥāfiẓ.

2. Define the mutawātir report, then mention its kinds and its conditions; then define the single-narrator report lexically and technically, and its kinds: the mashhūr, the 'azīz, the gharīb, the absolutely gharīb, and the relatively gharīb.
 3. What is the accepted report, what is its ruling, and what are the kinds of the report attended by corroborating indications?
And what is the ṣaḥīḥ in itself, and the ḥasan in itself, and what is it that they share in?
And what are the kinds of the ṣaḥīḥ with respect to the disparity of its ranks, and what is meant by "the condition of the two Shaykhs"?
 4. What is the ṣaḥīḥ by virtue of something else, and the ḥasan by virtue of something else?
And what is the manner of al-Tirmidhī's and others' combining of the ḥasan and authenticity, given that they are two disparate qualities?
And what is the manner of al-Tirmidhī's combining also of the ḥasan and the gharīb, given that the ḥasan in al-Tirmidhī's technical usage is what came by more than one route, and it is known that the gharīb is what a single narrator transmitted?
 5. What are the kinds of the addition of the trustworthy narrator, what is the ruling of each kind, and what is the maḥfūẓ, or the shādhidh, and the ma'rūf and the munkar among the reports?
And what is the mutāba'ah, and what are its kinds, and what is the mutābi', the shāhid, and the i'tibār?
And what is the muḥkam report and conflicting ḥadīth, and what is resorted to when two accepted reports conflict?
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[p. 26] Al-Khabar al-Mardūd wa-Asbāb Raddihi — The Rejected Report and the Causes of Its Rejection

Al-Khabar al-Mardūd: it is that in which the truthfulness of the one giving the report is not preponderant.

It is divided into many kinds, some of which have counted them as forty-odd kinds; and they go back, on the whole, to two causes:

The first of them is the dropping of a narrator, or more, from the isnād; and the second is impugning some of its narrators.

Anwā' al-Suqūṭ — The Kinds of Dropping

Dropping from the isnād is of two kinds: **manifest and evident**, such that participation in knowing it is obtained.

And hidden, which none perceives except the discerning experts who have looked into the routes of ḥadīth and the hidden defects of the isnāds.

The first is known by the narrator's not having met the one from whom he transmitted, either because he did not live in his time, or because he did live in his time but did not meet with him, and he has from him neither a licence to transmit (ijāzah) nor a written source (*wijādah*).

For this reason there is need of the science of chronology, because it comprises the fixing of the birth-dates of the narrators and their deaths, and the times of their seeking knowledge and their journeys.

Anwā' al-Mardūd bi-l'tibār al-Suqūṭ — The Kinds of the Rejected with Respect to Dropping

1 - **Al-Mu'allaq:** it is that from the beginning of whose isnād one narrator or more has been omitted.

The mu'allaq and the like of it are counted among the kinds of the rejected only because of ignorance of the state of the omitted narrator.

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Suspension (*ta'liq*) in the *Ṣaḥīḥ* of al-Bukhārī is frequent.

Al-Nawawī said: What of it is in the form of decisive assertion - such as: *qāla* (he said), *dhakara* (he mentioned), and *rawā* (he transmitted), in the active voice - is a ruling of its authenticity from the one to whom it is ascribed.

And what has no decisive assertion in it - such as: *qīla* (it was said), *dhukira* (it was mentioned), and *ruwiya* (it was transmitted), in the passive voice - has in it no ruling of its being authentic from the one to whom it is ascribed.

And the one who examines, if he wishes to argue by it, must look into the states of the men of its isnād.

2 - **Al-Mursal:** it is what the Successor raised to the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, as when he says: "The Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, said such-and-such", or "did such-and-such".

It is derived from their expression: *nāqah rasal*, that is, swift - as though the one transmitting in mursal

fashion (*al-mursil*) hastened to the ḥadīth and so omitted part of its isnād.

The mursal was counted among the kinds of the rejected for what we mentioned of ignorance regarding the state of the omitted narrator, because of the possibility that he is a Companion or a Successor; and upon the latter it is possible that he is trustworthy or other than trustworthy.

Ḥukm al-Mursal — The Ruling of the Mursal

The majority of the people of ḥadīth, and many of the jurists and the scholars of legal theory, held to rejecting the mursal, arguing that the transmission of an unknown narrator who is named, when it is not accepted, then the transmission of the mursal is more fitting [to be rejected], because the one transmitted from is omitted, unknown in person and in condition.

And it has been transmitted from the three leading authorities - Abū Ḥanīfah, and Mālik, and Aḥmad in one transmission from him - that the mursal is accepted absolutely.

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The argument of these is that keeping silent about the narrator, together with the integrity of the one keeping silent and his knowing that upon his transmission a general legal ruling is founded, is itself a report of that narrator's integrity - to the point that some of them said: The mursal is stronger than the musnad, because the one who gives the isnād has referred you to his isnād and to examining the states of its narrators and investigating them.

But whoever transmitted in mursal fashion, together with his knowledge, his religion, his leadership, his trustworthiness and his reliability, has decided for you as to its authenticity, and has spared you the burden of investigating the states of its narrators.

And some of the people of knowledge, among them Imam al-Shāfi'ī, held to accepting the mursal reports of the senior Successors, such as Sa'īd ibn al-Musayyab and the like, when there is joined to them what supports them - as when it is given an isnād from another quarter, or agrees with the statement of a Companion, or most of the people of knowledge give a legal opinion in accordance with its purport.

This, and what has preceded of the disagreement over the ruling of the mursal, is with regard to other than the mursal reports of the Companions, may Allah be pleased with them.

For the correct, well-known position, which the majority of the people of knowledge decisively affirmed, is that the mursal of a Companion is a proof; because the Companions' transmission from others than themselves is rare, and when they did transmit it they made it clear.

So when they state it absolutely, the outward appearance is that it is from the Companions - and they are all of them of integrity.

3 - **Al-Muḍḍal**: it is that from whose isnād two narrators or more have been omitted consecutively. It is derived from: *aḍḍalahu*, with the meaning of "it exhausted him".

4 - **Al-Munqaṭi'**: it is that from whose isnād one narrator, or more, has been omitted, not consecutively.

5 - **Al-Mudallas**: "*al-tadlīs*".

Al-Tadlīs is, lexically, concealing a fault; it is derived from *al-dalas*, which is darkness - for the one who practises *tadlīs* (*al-mudallis*) darkened the matter for the listener by covering over the true state of the case.

And tadrīs is of two kinds:

1 - **Tadrīs al-Isnād (tadrīs of the chain)**: it is that the narrator drops his shaykh and transmits from his shaykh's shaykh, or from another contemporary whom he met but from whom he did not hear, and he has from him neither a licence to transmit nor a written source, using a wording that admits of connection, such as *ʿan* (from) and *qāla* (he said).

The worst of its kinds is *tadrīs al-taswīyah*, which is that the narrator transmits a ḥadīth from a weak narrator standing between two trustworthy narrators, one of whom met the other; so he drops the weak one and transmits from his trustworthy shaykh, from the second trustworthy narrator.

Among the narrators known for that are: Baqiyyah ibn al-Walīd, and al-Walīd ibn Muslim al-Qurashī by clientage. Al-ʿIrāqī said it.

2 - **Tadrīs al-Shuyūkh (tadrīs of the shaykhs)**: it is that the narrator mentions his shaykh by that by which he is not well known among the people, of a name, or a *kunyah*, or a title, or the like of that.

Whoever is known for tadrīs from other than trustworthy narrators, his ḥadīth is not accepted until he states direct audition (*samāʿ*) explicitly.

6 - **Al-Mursal al-Khafī (the hidden mursal)**: it is what the narrator transmitted from a contemporary of his, whose meeting with him is not known, and he has from him neither a licence to transmit nor a written source, with a wording that gives the impression of connection, such as *ʿan* and *qāla*.

An example of that is what Ibn Mājah transmitted by the route of ʿUmar ibn ʿAbd al-ʿAzīz, from ʿUqbah ibn ʿĀmir, may Allah be pleased with him, from the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, that he said: "May Allah have mercy on the guard who keeps watch."

For ʿUmar did not meet ʿUqbah. Al-Ḥāfiẓ al-Mizzī said it in *al-Aṭrāf*.

[p. 30] Mā Yuʿraf bihi al-Tadrīs wa-l-Irsāl al-Khafī — What Tadrīs and Hidden Sending Are Known By

Tadrīs and hidden sending (*irsāl khafī*) are known by a number of things:

Among them: the report of the one who practised tadrīs, or the one who transmitted in mursal fashion, of that fact himself.

And among them: that it be known that he did not hear from the one he transmitted from, absolutely, or that he did not hear that particular ḥadīth, by an explicit statement of one of the leading authorities of this field.

[p. 31] Asbāb al-Ṭaʿn fī al-Rāwī — The Causes of Impugning the Narrator

The causes of impugning the narrator are ten, some of them more severely disparaging than others.

Five of them go back to the narrator's integrity, and they are: lying, the accusation of lying, open sinfulness, innovation, and being unknown.

And five go back to the narrator's precision, and they are: grossness of error, much heedlessness, delusion, contradicting the trustworthy narrators, and poor retention.

Here they are, arranged according to the severity of their effect in rejection:

The first cause: the narrator's lying against the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him. The report of the one who lies against him is called *al-mawḍūʿ* (fabricated).

Al-Khabar al-Mawḍūʿ wa-Ḥukm Riwāyatihi — The Fabricated Report and the Ruling on Transmitting It

Al-Waḍʿ, lexically: invention and fabrication. So the fabricated report is that which is invented and falsely attributed to the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him.

Transmitting fabricated reports is forbidden absolutely, except together with making clear their fabrication and exposing their defects, on account of the statement of the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him: "Whoever relates a ḥadīth from me which he considers to be a lie is one of the two liars." Muslim transmitted it.

Dawāʿ al-Waḍʿ — The Motives for Fabrication

The motives for fabrication and lying are many; among them are the following:

1 - **The intention of drawing near to Allah**, glorified be He, by fabricating what would make people desire obedience to Him and frighten them away from disobeying Him - as some of those attributed to asceticism and righteousness did.

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These are the worst of the fabricators and the severest of them in affliction and calamity, for people trust them and rely upon them because of their being ascribed to righteousness.

Among these are those who used to lie seeking reward and drawing near to Allah the Exalted: Abū ʿIṣmah Nūḥ ibn Abī Maryam al-Marwazī, judge of Marw, nicknamed *Nūḥ al-jāmiʿ*, who took jurisprudence from Abū Ḥanīfah and Ibn Abī Laylā.

It was said to him: From where do you have, from ʿIkrimah, from Ibn ʿAbbās, may Allah be pleased with them both, on the merits of the Qurʾān, sūrah by sūrah - and the companions of ʿIkrimah do not have this?

He said: I saw that the people had turned away from the Qurʾān and occupied themselves with the jurisprudence of Abū Ḥanīfah and the campaign-histories of Ibn Iṣḥāq, so I fabricated this ḥadīth seeking reward.

2 - **Ingratiating oneself with the ruling class** by fabricating what agrees with their whims - such as the story of Ghiyāth ibn Ibrāhīm al-Nakhaʿī al-Kūfī with the Commander of the Faithful al-Mahdī al-ʿAbbāsī. For he entered upon him, and he used to love pigeons and play with them; and there before him was a pigeon.

So he said: So-and-so related to us, from so-and-so - and he carried through its isnād - and said that the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, said: "There is no racing except in an arrow-head, or a hoof, or a solid hoof, or a wing."

So he added in the ḥadīth the wording: "or a wing". And al-Mahdī knew that he had lied for his sake, so he ordered that the pigeons be slaughtered.

The ḥadīth was transmitted by the compilers of the *Sunan* works, without the fabricated addition.

3 - **Corrupting the religion against its own people**, as the heretics (*zanādiqah*) did, who entered Islam in order to deceive the Muslims - such as Bayān ibn Samʿān, who claimed divinity for ʿAlī ibn Abī Ṭālib, may Allah be pleased with him; so Khālīd ibn ʿAbd Allāh al-Qasrī killed him and burned him.

4 - **Earning a living and gaining sustenance** by what they fabricate of reports, as is the way of the story-tellers.

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5 - **Championing an opinion.**

6 - **Peculiarity, for the purpose of becoming well known.**

Mā Yuʿraf bihi al-Waḍʿ — What Fabrication Is Known By

Fabrication is known by things, among them:

The fabricator's own admission of that - as Nūḥ ibn Abī Maryam, mentioned just now, admitted it.

And Maysarah ibn ʿAbd Rabbihi al-Fārisī, that he fabricated seventy ḥadīths on the merit of ʿAlī, may Allah be pleased with him.

And among them: that what is transmitted contradicts sense-perception in a way not admitting of interpretation - such as the ḥadīth: "The ark of Nūḥ circumambulated the House and prayed two rakʿahs behind the Station."

Al-Dhahabī mentioned it in *al-Mīzān*, from ʿAbd al-Raḥmān ibn Zayd ibn Aslam, from his father, from his grandfather - and he is weak.

Al-Sabab al-Thānī — The Second Cause

The accusation of lying: and that is that the narrator is known for lying in his speech with people, or that he is alone in transmitting what contradicts the rules of the religion that are known by necessity.

The report of the one accused of lying is called *al-matrūk*. Among its examples are the ḥadīths of Ṣadaqah al-Daḡiqī, from Farqad, from Samurah, from Abū Bakr, may Allah be pleased with him.

And the ḥadīths of ʿAmr ibn Shimr, from Jābir al-Juʿfī, from al-Ḥārith, from ʿAlī ibn Abī Ṭālib.

[p. 34] Al-Sabab al-Thālith wa-l-Rābiʿ wa-l-Khāmis — The Third, Fourth and Fifth Causes

Grossness of the narrator's error, his much heedlessness, and his open sinfulness in what does not amount to disbelief:

His report is called *al-munkar*, in the estimation of those who do not confine the munkar to what the weak narrator contradicted the trustworthy narrator in.

An example of that is what al-Nasā'ī and Ibn Mājah transmitted by the route of Abū Zukayr Yaḥyā ibn Muḥammad ibn Qays, from Hishām ibn 'Urwah, from his father, from 'Ā'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, as marfū': "Eat unripe dates with ripe dates, for when the son of Adam eats it, Satan is enraged."

Al-Nasā'ī said: This is a munkar ḥadīth in which Abū Zukayr Yaḥyā ibn Muḥammad was alone; and he is a righteous shaykh, except that he did not reach the level of one whose being alone is accepted.

Al-Sabab al-Sādis — The Sixth Cause

The narrator's delusion (*wahm*): it is that he transmits the ḥadīth by way of a mistaken supposition.

Delusion, just as it occurs in the isnād - by raising a mawqūf, or connecting a disconnected report - occurs in the matn, by introducing one ḥadīth into another.

Delusion may be impugning, such as declaring a defect by *irsāl*; and it may be non-impugning, such as declaring a defect by a narrator's delusion regarding the name of one of the men of the isnād.

The governing principle of that is: the report cannot but be either solitary, or have more than one route.

From the first there necessarily follows, from impugning in its isnād, impugning in its matn, and the reverse; and from the second there does not necessarily follow, from impugning in one of the two, impugning in the other.

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The report in which delusion occurs is called: *al-mu'all* and *al-mu'allal* (defective).

It is among the most obscure of the sciences of ḥadīth; none perceives it except one whom Allah has granted a penetrating mind and wide acquaintance with the ranks of the narrators and with the texts.

An example of delusion in the isnād, which is non-impugning, is the ḥadīth of Ya'lā ibn 'Ubayd al-Ṭanāfisī, one of the men of the *Ṣaḥīḥ*, from Sufyān al-Thawrī, from 'Amr ibn Dīnār, from Ibn 'Umar, may Allah be pleased with them both, from the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him: "The two parties to a sale have the right of option" - the ḥadīth.

Ya'lā ibn 'Ubayd had a delusion against Sufyān in his saying "'Amr ibn Dīnār"; whereas the well-known form is from the ḥadīth of Sufyān, from 'Abd Allāh ibn Dīnār, from Ibn 'Umar, may Allah be pleased with them both.

Ibn Ma'in said: Ya'lā ibn 'Ubayd is weak in [transmitting from] al-Thawrī, trustworthy in others.

And an example of delusion in the matn is the ḥadīth of Abū Sa'īd ibn Abī Maryam, from Mālik, from al-Zuhrī, from Anas, may Allah be pleased with him, as marfū': "Do not hate one another, and do not envy one another, and do not turn your backs on one another, and do not vie with one another."

For his saying "and do not vie with one another" - Ibn Abī Maryam introduced it into the ḥadīth from another ḥadīth of Mālik's, from Abū al-Zinād, from al-A'raj, from Abū Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, as marfū': "Beware of suspicion, for suspicion is the most lying of speech. And do not spy, and do not pry, and do not vie with one another, and do not envy one another."

And the two ḥadīths are agreed upon, except for the wording: "and do not vie with one another" - Muslim alone transmitted it.

Delusion is known by the narrator's being alone, and by his contradicting others, together with corroborating indications that are joined to that.

And the way to knowing it is gathering the routes of the ḥadīth and looking into the difference of its narrators in precision and exactitude.

‘Alī ibn al-Madīnī said: The rule is that if you do not gather its routes, its error does not become clear.

[p. 36] Al-Sabab al-Sābi‘ — The Seventh Cause

The narrator's contradicting the trustworthy narrators. Contradiction comprises six kinds:

1. **Al-Mudraj (the interpolated)**, with a fathāh on the rā’; it is derived from *adrajtu al-shay’ fī al-shay’* (I inserted the thing into the thing) when you entered it into it and included it within it. And it is of two kinds:

The first: Mudraj al-Isnād, which is: that in which the running-on of its isnād has been altered.

Among its forms is: that the narrator has two ḥadīths with two different isnāds, and he transmits them both with one of the two; or he transmits one of the two with the isnād particular to it, and adds into it something from the other ḥadīth.

And among them: that he has the matn of the isnād except for a portion of it, for he has that portion by another isnād, so he transmits it in full with the first isnād.

And among them: that he hears the report from his shaykh except for a portion of it, so he hears that portion from him through an intermediary, then transmits it in full with the intermediary omitted.

And among them: that he hears the report from a group who differ in its isnād, so he transmits it from them as agreed upon, without making clear their difference.

The second: Mudraj al-Matn, which is: that into whose matn there has been entered, and joined to it, what is not part of it, without any separation.

Most commonly interpolation occurs at the end of the report, and its occurrence at the beginning is more frequent than in the middle.

Among its examples is what al-Khaṭīb transmitted by the route of Abū Qaṭan and Shabābah, from Shu‘bah, from Muḥammad ibn Ziyād, from Abū Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, as marfū‘: "Perform the ablution completely - and woe to the heels from the Fire."

For his saying "Perform the ablution completely" is interpolated, being from the speech of Abū Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him.

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For al-Bukhārī transmitted the ḥadīth by the route of Ādam ibn Abī Iyās, from Shu‘bah, from Muḥammad ibn Ziyād, from Abū Hurayrah, who said: "Perform the ablution completely, for Abū al-Qāsim, peace and blessings be upon him, said: 'Woe to the heels from the Fire.'"

And al-Khaṭīb said, after mentioning the ḥadīth: Abū Qaṭan and Shabābah ibn Sawwār were subject to delusion in their transmission of this ḥadīth from Shu‘bah, as against what we have set out.

And among them: the ḥadīth of Ibn Mas‘ūd, may Allah be pleased with him, who said: The Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, said:

"Belief in omens is polytheism; and there is none among us but [that it occurs to him], yet Allah removes it by trust in Him." Al-Tirmidhī transmitted it, and said: "a ḥasan ṣaḥīḥ ḥadīth".

And he said: I heard Muḥammad [al-Bukhārī] say concerning this - his statement "and there is none among us but": in my view it is from the speech of Ibn Mas'ūd, may Allah be pleased with him.

Dawā'ī al-Idrāj wa-Ḥukmuḥu wa-Mā Yu'raf bihi — The Motives for Interpolation, Its Ruling, and What It Is Known By

The motives for interpolation are many; among them: **explaining unfamiliar words**.

And among them: **deriving a legal ruling from the speech of the Prophet**, peace and blessings be upon him.

And among them: **making a legal ruling clear**.

Interpolation is not permissible except for what is an explanation of an unfamiliar word, for that is not forbidden, as al-Zuhrī and others of the leading authorities did.

Interpolation is known by a number of things, among them:

That some of the narrators state explicitly the separating off of that interpolated expression and attribute it to the one who said it.

And among them: that ascribing that to the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, is impossible.

[p. 38] 2 - Al-Khabar al-Maqlūb — The Inverted Report

Al-Khabar al-Maqlūb - and it is also called *al-munqalib* - is: that some of whose wording has been inverted with respect to a narrator, so that its meaning has changed.

Inversion (*al-qalb*) occurs in the isnād just as it occurs in the matn.

Of the first is: that the ḥadīth is well known by a narrator, and another narrator of his level is put in his place, for the purpose of peculiarity and the like.

Among the narrators who used to do that was Ḥammād ibn 'Amr al-Naṣībī, ascribed to the people of Naṣībīn. Al-Bukhārī said: He is munkar in ḥadīth.

Among its examples is the ḥadīth: "When you meet the polytheists on a road, do not begin them with the greeting of peace."

Ḥammād ibn 'Amr inverted it and transmitted it from al-A'mash, from Abū Ṣāliḥ, from Abū Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, as marfū'; whereas it is only from Suhayl ibn Abī Ṣāliḥ, from his father, from Abū Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, as in *Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim*.

And of inversion in the isnād is what occurs in the names of the narrators by putting first and putting last - such as Murrah ibn Ka'b and Ka'b ibn Murrah: the name of one of them is the father's name of the other.

And an example of inversion in the matn is what Muslim transmitted from the ḥadīth of the seven whom Allah will shade in His shade on a day when there is no shade but His shade; and in it: "and a man who gave charity and concealed it, so that his right hand did not know what his left hand spent"; whereas it is only: "so that his left hand did not know what his right hand spends", as al-Bukhārī transmitted it, and Muslim in one of his two transmissions of the ḥadīth.

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And of inversion is: that the isnād of one matn is taken and placed upon another matn, and the matn of this one is taken and placed with another isnād - as the people of Baghdad did with the Commander of the Faithful in ḥadīth, Imam al-Bukhārī.

Al-Khaṭīb mentioned that in his *Tārīkh*, and Ibn Ḥajar in his *Nukat* upon Ibn al-Ṣalāḥ.

3 - Al-Mazīd fī Muttaṣil al-Asānīd — The Addition in Connected Isnāds

Al-Mazīd fī muttaṣil al-asānīd: it is that in which the contradiction consisted of the addition of a narrator in the middle of an isnād outwardly appearing connected.

The ruling in that is to give consideration to the isnād devoid of the addition, if the one who did not add it was more exacting than the one who added, at the place of the addition, with explicit statement of direct audition; otherwise that addition is preferred.

An example of that is what Muslim and al-Tirmidhī transmitted by the route of ‘Abd Allāh ibn al-Mubārak, from ‘Abd al-Raḥmān ibn Yazīd ibn Jābir, from Busr ibn ‘Ubayd Allāh, from - Abū Idrīs al-Khawlānī - from Wāthilah ibn al-Asqa’, from Abū Murshid al-Ghanawī, may Allah be pleased with him, who said: The Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, said: "Do not sit upon the graves and do not pray towards them."

Abū ‘Īsā al-Tirmidhī said: Muḥammad ibn Ismā‘īl [al-Bukhārī] said: The ḥadīth of Ibn al-Mubārak has a mistake in which Ibn al-Mubārak erred, for he added in it: "from Abū Idrīs" - whereas it is only Busr ibn ‘Ubayd Allāh from Wāthilah.

[p. 40] 4 - Al-Muḍṭarib — The Shaky Report

Al-Muḍṭarib, with a kasrah on the rā’, is: what is transmitted in various differing modes, equal in strength. This holds whether the difference is from a single narrator - in that he transmitted it one time in one mode and another time in another mode contradicting the first - or from more than one, in that a group transmitted it, each in a mode contradicting the other.

Shakiness (*al-idṭirāb*) necessitates the weakness of the ḥadīth, because of its signalling the lack of precision of its narrators; and it occurs in the isnād, and in the matn, and in both of them.

Then, if one of the modes is preferred by the precision of its narrator, or by his greater companionship with the one transmitted from, or by other than that among the modes of preference, then the ruling is for the preferred mode; and the description of shakiness is not then applied to the ḥadīth, nor does it take its ruling.

Among its examples in the matn is what al-Tirmidhī transmitted from Sharīk, from Abū Ḥamzah, from al-Shaʿbī, from Fāṭimah bint Qays, may Allah be pleased with her, who said: The Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, was asked about zakāt, and he said: "Indeed in wealth there is a due besides zakāt."

And Ibn Mājah transmitted it by the very same route with the wording: "There is no due in wealth besides zakāt."

Al-Ḥāfiẓ al-ʿIrāqī said: This is a shakiness that does not admit of interpretation.

And it is said: interpreting it is possible, in that she transmitted both wordings from him, peace and blessings be upon him, and the due that is affirmed is the non-obligatory one, such as voluntary charity and honouring the guest, while the due that is negated is the obligatory one. And Allah knows best.

[p. 41] 5 - Al-Muṣaḥḥaf — The Misread Report

Al-Muṣaḥḥaf: it is that in which the contradiction consisted of altering a letter, or more, with respect to the dotting, while the form of the script remains.

It occurs in the isnād and in the matn.

Of the first is the ḥadīth of Shuʿbah, from al-ʿAwwām ibn Murājim - with the undotted rāʾ and the jīm - from Abū ʿUthmān al-Nahdī, from ʿUthmān ibn ʿAffān, may Allah be pleased with him, who said: The Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, said: "You shall surely render the dues to those entitled to them." Yaḥyā ibn Maʿīn misread it and said: "al-ʿAwwām ibn Muzāḥim", with the zāy and the ḥāʾ in place of the rāʾ and the jīm.

And the ḥadīth was transmitted by Muslim, by the route of Abū Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him. And of the second is the ḥadīth: "Whoever fasts Ramaḍān and follows it with six from Shawwāl" - the ḥadīth. Muslim transmitted it.

Abū Bakr al-Ṣūlī misread it and said: "something (*shayʿan*) of Shawwāl" instead of "six (*sittan*)", with the dotted shīn and the yāʾ with dots beneath.

[p. 41] 6 - Al-Muḥarraf — The Miswritten Report

Al-Muḥarraf: it is that in which the contradiction consisted of altering a letter, or more, with respect to the vowelling, while the form of the script remains.

Of alteration (*taḥrīf*) in the isnād is: substituting "ʿAqīl", with a fathah on the ʿayn, for "ʿUqayl", with a dammah, and the like of that.

And its example in the matn: the ḥadīth of Jābir, may Allah be pleased with him: "Ubayy was struck on the day of the Confederates in his median vein" - the ḥadīth.

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Ghundar altered it and said: "My father (*abī*) was struck", in the construct form. Whereas it is only Ubayy ibn Kaʿb; and the father of Jābir was martyred on the day of Uḥud.

Al-Sabab al-Thāmin — The Eighth Cause

Being unknown as regards the narrator, and its cause is two things:

The first: that the narrator's designations are numerous - of name, or *kunyah*, or title, or trade, or lineage, or the like - and he is mentioned by that by which he is not well known, for some purpose; so it is supposed that he is someone else, and ignorance of his state results.

An example of that: Muḥammad ibn al-Sā'ib al-Kalbī.

Some of them ascribed him to his grandfather and said: Muḥammad ibn Bishr. And some named him Ḥammād ibn al-Sā'ib; and some gave him the *kunyah* Abū al-Naḍr, and some Abū Hishām, and some Abū Sa'īd. So he came to be thought a group, whereas he is one person.

And there has been composed on it: *al-Mūḍiḥ li-Awhām al-Jam' wa-l-Tafrīq* [The Clarification of the Delusions of Combining and Separating] in designations.

The second: that the narrator transmits little in ḥadīth, so that transmission from him and taking from him is not frequent.

And there has been composed on it: *al-Wuḥḍān* [The Solitary Ones].

Anwā' al-Majhūl — The Kinds of the Unknown Narrator

The unknown narrator is of two kinds:

1 - **Majhūl al-'Ayn (unknown in person)**, which is: he from whom none but one person transmitted; and the ruling of his transmission is rejection, unless he is declared trustworthy - even if by the narrator transmitting from him, if that one is of the people of criticism and authentication (al-jarḥ wa-l-ta'dīl).

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2 - **Majhūl al-Ḥāl (unknown in condition)**, and he is also called *al-mastūr*, and he is the one from whom more than one transmitted, without his being declared trustworthy; and the ruling of his transmission is suspension until his state becomes clear.

Al-Mubham wa-Ḥukm Riwāyatihi — The Unnamed Narrator and the Ruling on His Transmission

Al-Mubham is: the one whose name is not stated explicitly, for the sake of brevity and the like - as when the narrator says of him: "A trustworthy narrator informed me", or "a shaykh", or "a man", or the like of that.

The ruling of his transmission is non-acceptance, upon the more correct position, even if he is left unnamed with a wording of authentication - as when it is said: "A trustworthy one informed me", or "an established one" - because he may not be trustworthy in the estimation of another.

Al-Sabab al-Tāsi' — The Ninth Cause

Innovation (al-bid'ah). And *al-ibtidā'* is: invention; and in the Sacred Law it is: what is newly introduced into the religion.

And innovation is of two kinds:

1 - **Innovation amounting to disbelief**, whose adherent is thereby a disbeliever, by his denying a matter agreed upon, transmitted by mutawātir transmission, known in the religion by necessity: this one, his transmission is not accepted.

2 - **Innovation amounting to open sinfulness**, whose adherent is thereby openly sinful; and his transmission is accepted so long as he is not a caller to his innovation, nor one who conveys what promotes it. This is what the majority chose, and it is the correct position.

Al-Sabab al-‘Āshir — The Tenth Cause

Poor retention. What is meant by "of poor retention" is: he whose correctness is not preponderant over his error.

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And it is of two kinds:

The first: he whose poor retention arose from the outset and clung to him in all his states.

His report is called: *al-shādhah*, in the estimation of some.

The second: he upon whom poor retention came about later, through his advanced age, or the loss of his eyesight, or the loss of his books, or the like of that: this one they call *al-mukhtaliṭ* (the one whose memory became confused).

The ruling of his transmission is that what he related before his confusion, and it is known, is accepted; and what he related after it is not accepted; and what is not distinguishable is suspended.

[p. 44] As’ilah wa-Tamārīn — Questions and Exercises

1. What are the causes of the rejection of a report? And how many are the categories of the rejected with respect to dropping from the isnād? And what is the definition of each kind?
2. What is manifest dropping, and by what is it known, and what is hidden dropping? And what is the difference between the mudallas and the hidden mursal?
3. Name the following: a report from whose isnād two consecutive narrators have been omitted; another, from the beginning of whose isnād, and from its middle, two non-consecutive narrators [have been omitted].

And a report which the narrator transmitted from a contemporary of his from whom he did not hear, and no meeting between the two is known; and another like that, except that his having met him is known.

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4. How many modes are there of impugning the narrator? And which of them impugns his integrity and which impugns his precision?

And what is the fabricated report and what is the ruling on transmitting it? And what is the matrūk, and what is meant by the accusation of lying? Explain that, making clear some of the motives for fabrication and some of what fabrication is known by.

5. By what is the report of one whose error is gross, or who is much given to heedlessness, or who is openly sinful, called?

And what is the mu‘all report?

And what is the mudraj in the matn and the mudraj in the isnād, and what is the ruling of interpolation, and by what is it known?

And what is the muḍṭarib, and when does shakiness impugn?

And what are the muṣaḥḥaf and the muḥarraf? Explain them with an example.

6. How many are the causes of being unknown as regards the narrator? And who is the one unknown in person, the one unknown in condition, and the unnamed narrator? And what is the ruling of the transmission of each?

And what is innovation in the Sacred Law, and into how many kinds is it divided? And what is the ruling of the transmission of an innovator?

And what is meant by "of poor retention", and who is the *mukhtaliṭ*, and what is the ruling of his transmission?

[p. 46] Taqsīm al-Khabar ilā Marfū‘ wa-Mawqūf wa-Maqṭū‘ — The Division of the Report into Marfū‘, Mawqūf and Maqṭū‘

The report is divided, with respect to the end-point of its isnād, into marfū‘, mawqūf, and maqṭū‘.

Al-Marfū‘ wa-Anwā‘uhu — The Marfū‘ and Its Kinds

Al-Marfū‘: what is ascribed to the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, of a statement, an act, or a tacit approval, whether explicitly or by implication of the ruling. And its kinds are six, which are:

1 - **The explicitly marfū‘ in statement**: such as that the Companion says: "I heard the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, say such-and-such"; or that he, or someone other than he, says: "The Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, used to say such-and-such."

2 - **The explicitly marfū‘ in act**: such as that the Companion says: "I saw the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, do such-and-such"; or that he, or someone other than he, says: "The Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, used to do such-and-such."

3 - **The explicitly marfū‘ in tacit approval**: such as that the Companion says: "I did such-and-such in the presence of the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him"; or that he, or someone other than he, says: "So-and-so did such-and-such in the presence of the Prophet" - and he does not mention his disapproval of that.

4 - **The marfū‘ in statement by implication of the ruling**: such as that a Companion who is not known for taking from the People of the Book says something in which there is no scope for opinion and independent reasoning, and which has no connection with explaining an unfamiliar word or expounding a difficulty - such as his reporting about matters past,

like the beginning of creation and the like; or his reporting about matters to come, such as the trials and the states of the Resurrection; and likewise his reporting about what is obtained by an act of a specific reward or a specific punishment.

5 - **The marfū' in act by implication of the ruling:** such as that the Companion does an act in which there is no scope for opinion - such as 'Alī ibn Abī Ṭālib's, may Allah be pleased with him, praying the eclipse prayer with more than two bowings in each rak'ah.

6 - **The marfū' in tacit approval by implication of the ruling:** such as that the Companion reports that "they used to do such-and-such in the time of the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him", and he did not disapprove of them.

Among the formulations that have the ruling of being raised (*raf'*) is the Companion's statement: "It is from the Sunnah, such-and-such"; "We were commanded with such-and-such"; "We were forbidden from such-and-such"; or that the Companion rules concerning an act that it is obedience to Allah the Exalted or to His Messenger, peace and blessings be upon him, or that it is disobedience - such as the statement of 'Ammār ibn Yāsir, may Allah be pleased with him: "Whoever fasts on the day of doubt has disobeyed Abū al-Qāsim, peace and blessings be upon him." The compilers of the *Sunan* works transmitted it, and al-Bukhārī noted a hidden defect in it.

Al-Mawqūf, al-Ṣaḥābī, wa-Mā Tu'raf bihi al-Ṣuḥbah — The Mawqūf, the Companion, and What Companionship Is Known By

Al-Mawqūf: what is ascribed to the Companion, of a statement, an act, or a tacit approval.

And the Ṣaḥābī (Companion): he is the one who met the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, believing in him, and died upon Islam - even if apostasy intervened in between, upon the more correct position.

Companionship is known by mutawātir transmission, or by widespread report, or by the report of some of the Companions or some of the trustworthy Successors, or by his own report about himself that he is a Companion, if his claim is possible.

[p. 48] Al-Maqtū' wa-l-Farq baynahu wa-bayna al-Munqaṭi' — The Maqtū' and the Difference Between It and the Munqaṭi'

Al-Maqtū': what is ascribed to the Successor, or to one below him, of a statement or an act.

The difference between the maqtū' and the munqaṭi' technically is that the first is a description among the descriptions of the matn - like being raised (*raf'*) and being stopped (*waqf*) - while the other is a description among the descriptions of the isnād, like suspension (*ta'īl*) and sending (*irsāl*).

And the Tābi' (Successor): he is the one who met a Companion as a believer and died upon Islam.

Al-Mukhaḍram — The Mukhaḍram

Al-Mukhaḍram: he is the one who lived through the pre-Islamic age and the time of the Messenger, peace and blessings be upon him, but did not meet him.

The mukhaḍrams are more than twenty persons, among them: al-Aḥnaf ibn Qays, Abū Muslim al-Khawlānī, Abū Rajā' al-ʿUṭṭarī, and Abū ʿUthmān al-Nahdī.

And they are among the Successors, upon the correct position.

[p. 49] Al-ʿUluww wa-l-Nuzūl — Elevation and Descent [of the Isnād]

Allah the Exalted singled out this community with the connected isnād to its Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him.

ʿAbd Allāh ibn al-Mubārak said: The isnād is part of the religion; were it not for the isnād, whoever wished would say whatever he wished. Muslim transmitted it.

And Sufyān al-Thawrī said: The isnād is the weapon of the believer.

Elevation (al-ʿuluww) is an expression for the fewness of the men of the isnād, **and descent (al-nuzūl)** for their being many; and the two are among the descriptions of the isnād.

Elevation of the isnād is better than descent in it, on condition that the elevated isnād be free of weakness. As for when it comes with weakness, there is no merit in it - especially if it includes some of the liars or those accused of lying.

Ibn al-Ṣalāḥ said: Elevation distances the isnād from defect, because each one of its men is liable for defect to occur from his side, whether inadvertently or deliberately; so in their fewness lies the fewness of the sides from which defect may come.

Taqṣīm al-Khabar ilā ʿĀlin wa-Nāzil — The Division of the Report into Elevated and Descending

The report is divided, with respect to the elevation and descent of its isnād, into two categories:

1 - **Al-Khabar al-ʿĀlī (the elevated report):** it is that whose isnād's men are few, relative to another isnād by which that report comes with a large number.

2 - **Al-Khabar al-Nāzil (the descending report):** it is that whose isnād's men are many, relative to another isnād by which that report comes with a small number.

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Each of the elevated and the descending is of two kinds: absolute and relative.

The absolutely elevated: it is that whose isnād terminates at the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, with a small number, relative to another isnād by which the report comes with a large number.

And its opposite is the absolutely descending; and it is clear.

And the relatively elevated: it is that whose isnād terminates at a well-known leading authority among the leading authorities of ḥadīth - such as Mālik and Shu‘bah, for example - with a small number, relative to another isnād by which that report comes with a large number; and its opposite is the relatively descending.

Anwā‘ al-Nisbī — The Kinds of the Relative

Four kinds branch off from the relative:

1 - **Al-Muwāfaqah (concurrence):** it is that the narrator arrives at the shaykh of one of the compilers - such as al-Bukhārī, for example - by other than his route, with elevation of his isnād over the isnād of the compiler.

Al-Ḥāfiẓ gave an example of that: that al-Bukhārī transmits a ḥadīth from Qutaybah, from Mālik, for example. He said: If we transmitted it by the route of al-Bukhārī, there would be between us and Qutaybah eight [men]; and if we transmitted it by the route of Abū al-‘Abbās al-Sarrāj, from Qutaybah, there would be between us and Qutaybah seven. So there has been obtained for us concurrence with al-Bukhārī in his shaykh Qutaybah, together with elevation.

2 - **Al-Badal**, and it is also called *al-ibdāl* (substitution), and it is: arriving at the shaykh of the shaykh of one of the compilers by other than his route, with elevation of the isnād over the isnād to him.

An example of that is what al-Ḥāfiẓ said, pointing to the example of the aforementioned concurrence: That that very isnād occurs to us by another route, other than the route of al-Bukhārī

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to al-Qa‘nabī, from Mālik; so that al-Qa‘nabī in it is a substitute for Qutaybah, the shaykh of al-Bukhārī.

Most of what is taken into consideration in each of concurrence and substitution is when we join elevation to it; otherwise the two occur without it.

3 - **Al-Musāwāh (parity):** it is that the number of the men of the narrator's isnād is equal to the isnād of one of the compilers.

An example of that is what occurred to al-Ḥāfiẓ Ibn Ḥajar of ḥadīths in which there were between him and the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, ten men.

And there occurred for al-Tirmidhī and al-Nasā‘ī this very same number; and it is what al-Tirmidhī transmitted on the merit of Sūrat al-Ikhlāṣ, and al-Nasā‘ī transmitted in the Book of Prayer, from Abū Ayyūb, may Allah be pleased with him, as marfū‘: "'Say: He is Allah, One' equals a third of the Qur‘ān." He said: I do not know an isnād longer than the isnād of this ḥadīth; and in it are six of the Successors.

Al-Ḥāfiẓ Ibn Ḥajar has a fascicle in which he gathered ten ḥadīths, and he named it *al-‘Asharah al-‘Ushāriyyah* [The Ten Ten-Link Ḥadīths].

Al-Ḥāfiẓ al-‘Irāqī said: Parity used to be found in former times; but as for today, it is possible in the number absolutely, not in a particular ḥadīth.

4 - **Al-Muṣāfahah (the handshake):** it is that the narrator's isnād is equal in number to the isnād of a student of one of the compilers.

So the narrator is as though he met the compiler and transmitted from him. It was named thus because custom has run with shaking hands between two who have met.

[p. 52] Riwāyat al-Aqrān wa-l-Mudabbaj — The Transmission of Peers and the Mudabbaj

Riwāyat al-Aqrān (the transmission of peers): *al-qarīnān* are the two who are close together in age and in taking from the shaykhs.

And riwāyat al-aqrān is: that one peer transmits from his peer - such as the transmission of al-Aʿmash from al-Taymī.

Al-Mudabbaj: with a fathah on the undotted dāl and a shaddah on the single-dotted bāʾ; it is derived from the *dībājātān* of the face, which are the two cheeks, on account of their equality and their facing one another.

And technically it is: that each of the two peers transmits from the other - such as the transmission of the Mother of the Believers ʿĀʾishah from Abū Hurayrah and his transmission from her; and such as the transmission of Mālik and al-Awzāʾī [from each other], and the transmission of Aḥmad ibn Ḥanbal and ʿAlī ibn al-Madīnī, each from the other.

The mudabbaj is absolutely more specific than the peers. Among the benefits of knowing this kind is safety from supposing that there is an addition in the isnād, or supposing that "ʿan" has been substituted for "wa".

Riwāyat al-Akābir ʿan al-Aṣāghir wa-ʿAks Dhālik — The Transmission of Seniors from Juniors, and the Reverse

Riwāyat al-akābir ʿan al-aṣāghir (the transmission of seniors from juniors): it is a person's transmission from one below him in age, or in knowledge and retention - such as the transmission of Muḥammad ibn Shihāb al-Zuhrī from Mālik, and the transmission of Mālik from ʿAbd Allāh ibn Dīnār. And of this kind is the transmission of the Companions from the Successors, such as the transmission of the ʿAbādilah and others from Kaʿb al-Aḥbār; and the transmission of fathers from sons.

Among the benefits of knowing this kind is safety from supposing that there is inversion in the isnād, because custom has run with the transmission of juniors from seniors.

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And riwāyat al-aṣāghir ʿan al-akābir (the transmission of juniors from seniors): it is a person's transmission from one above him in age, or in knowledge and retention. And it is the path commonly trodden.

And of this kind is the transmission of sons from fathers, and from fathers from grandfathers.

Al-Sābiq wa-l-Lāḥiq — The Earlier and the Later

Al-Sābiq wa-l-lāḥiq: it is that two narrators - one earlier and one later in death - share in transmitting from a single shaykh, with a wide distance between their two deaths.

Among its examples: Abū al-ʿAbbās al-Sarrāj, the shaykh of al-Bukhārī and Muslim.

Al-Bukhārī and Abū al-Ḥusayn al-Khaffāf transmitted from him, and between their two deaths is about one hundred and forty years - because al-Bukhārī died in the year two hundred and fifty-six, and al-Khaffāf in the year three hundred and ninety-three, or ninety-four, or ninety-five.

And among them: Imam Mālik - al-Zuhrī transmitted from him, and he died in the year 124; and Aḥmad ibn Ismāʿīl al-Sahmī, who died in the year 259; and between their two deaths is one hundred and thirty-five years.

Among the benefits of knowing this kind is safety from supposing that the isnād of the later one is disconnected.

Al-Muhmal — The Undifferentiated

Al-Muhmal: it is that the narrator transmits from two shaykhs who agree in name, or in name and father's name, or the like of that, and he does not differentiate them by what particularises each one of them.

If the two shaykhs are trustworthy, ignorance of them does not do harm; and of that is what occurred to al-Bukhārī in his transmission from "Aḥmad", from Ibn Wahb.

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For he is either Aḥmad ibn Ṣāliḥ or Aḥmad ibn ʿIsā, and both of them are trustworthy.

But if one of the two is trustworthy and the other weak, the ignorance does harm - such as: Sulaymān ibn Dāwūd al-Khawlānī, and he is trustworthy; and Sulaymān ibn Dāwūd al-Yamāmī, and he is weak.

The difference between the muhmal and the mubham is that the muhmal's name is mentioned, together with the ambiguity, whereas the mubham's name is not mentioned.

Man Ḥaddatha wa-Nasiya — He Who Related and Then Forgot

Man ḥaddatha wa-nasiya: it is that the shaykh denies the transmission of what his student related from him.

The ruling of that which is transmitted is rejection, if the shaykh denied it by way of decisive assertion and certainty - as when he says: "I did not relate that to him", or "he is lying against me", or the like of that.

And the rejection is not impugning of the integrity of either one of them, since neither of them has more claim than the other to be impugned.

But if he denied it by way of hesitation and doubt - as when he says: "I do not recall", or "I do not know it", or the like of that - then what is transmitted is accepted, taken as the shaykh's forgetting and the student's recalling; for the one who decisively affirms takes precedence over the one who hesitantly negates.

Al-Dāraquṭnī has a composition on this kind, which he named: *Man Ḥaddatha wa-Nasiya* [He Who Related and Then Forgot].

An example of that is what Abū Dāwūd and al-Tirmidhī transmitted from the ḥadīth of Suhayl ibn Abī Ṣāliḥ, from his father, from Abū Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, as marfūʿ, in the story of the [single] witness and the oath.

‘Abd al-‘Azīz ibn Muḥammad al-Darāwardī said: Rabī‘ah ibn Abī ‘Abd al-Raḥmān related it to me from Suhayl; then I met Suhayl and asked him about it, and he did not know it. So I said: "Rabī‘ah related to me from you such-and-such."

So Suhayl came, after that, to say: "‘Abd al-‘Azīz related to me, from Rabī‘ah, from me, that I related it to him, from Abū Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, as marfū‘, with such-and-such."

Al-Musalsal — The Chained Ḥadīth

Al-Musalsal: it is that in which its narrators, or some of them, agree upon a description of the narrators or of the transmission.

The descriptions of the narrators are their statements and their acts; and the descriptions of the transmission are what pertains to the formulations of conveying it, or to its time or its place. And it is a very broad kind.

Among its benefits is its containing an added measure of precision on the part of its narrators.

Among its examples is what al-Ḥāfiẓ Ibn ‘Asākir transmitted in his *Tārīkh*: He said: Abū al-Ḥasan ‘Alī ibn Muslim the jurist related to us - and he took hold of his beard - ‘Abd al-‘Azīz ibn Aḥmad related to us - and he took hold of his beard - Abū ‘Amr ‘Uthmān ibn Abī Bakr informed us - and he took hold of his beard - Muḥammad ibn Ishāq al-‘Abdī related to us - and he took hold of his beard - Aḥmad ibn Mihrān informed us - and he took hold of his beard - Sulaymān ibn Shu‘ayb al-Kaysānī related to us - and he took hold of his beard - Shihāb ibn Khirāsh related to us - and he took hold of his beard - Yazīd al-Raqāshī related to us - and he took hold of his beard - Anas ibn Mālik, may Allah be pleased with him, related to us - and he took hold of his beard - he said: I heard the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, say: "A servant does not believe until he believes in the divine decree, its good and its evil, its sweet and its bitter."

And the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, took hold of his beard and said: "I believe in the divine decree, its good and its evil, its sweet and its bitter."

And among the examples is what Abū Dāwūd and al-Nasā’ī transmitted from Mu‘ādh, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, said to Mu‘ādh: "Indeed I love you; so say at the end of every prayer: 'O Allah, help me to remember You, to thank You, and to worship You well.'"

For it has been chained by the statement of every one who transmitted it to the one it was transmitted to: "Indeed I love you, O so-and-so; so say at the end of every prayer: 'O Allah, help me...' and so on.

Al-Muttafiq wa-l-Muftariq, al-Mu’talif wa-l-Mukhtalif, al-Mutashābih — The Agreeing-and-Differing, the Concordant-and-Discordant, and the Resembling

Among the most important of the kinds of the sciences of ḥadīth are: *al-muttafiq wa-l-muftariq*, *al-mu’talif wa-l-mukhtalif*, and *al-mutashābih*, among names, titles, and lineages.

Whoever does not know that, among those who occupy themselves with ḥadīth, is not safe from stumbling, and is not spared wounding disparagement.

Al-Muttafiq wa-l-muftariq: it is that in which the names of the narrators agree - or [the names] together with the names of the fathers and upward - in utterance and in script, while their persons differ. Such as: ‘Abd Allāh ibn ‘Umar and ‘Abd Allāh ibn ‘Amr; and ‘Abd Allāh ibn Zayd ibn ‘Āṣim and ‘Abd Allāh ibn Zayd ibn ‘Abd Rabbihi.

The benefit of knowing this kind is safety from confusion, for a multiplicity may be supposed to be one - as occurred to some of them; and one of the two who share [a name] may be weak, so that a trustworthy narrator is declared weak and a weak one is declared trustworthy.

Al-Mu’talif wa-l-mukhtalif: it is that the names, or the titles, or the lineages agree in script and differ in pronunciation. It is: *Miswar*, with a kasrah on the mīm, a sukūn on the undotted sīn, and a faṭḥah on the unstressed wāw.

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And *Musawwir*, with a ḍammah on the mīm, a faṭḥah on the sīn, and a shaddah on the wāw with a kasrah.

And *Salām* with lightening, and *Sallām* with the shaddah.

The benefit of knowing this kind is safety from misreading and miswriting.

Al-Mutashābih (the resembling): it is composed of the two preceding kinds together: that the names of the narrators agree in utterance and in script, while the names of the fathers differ in utterance but not in script, or the reverse.

Such as: Muḥammad ibn ‘Aqīl, with a faṭḥah on the undotted ‘ayn, and Muḥammad ibn ‘Uqayl, with the ḍammah.

And Shurayḥ ibn al-Nu‘mān, with the dotted shīn and the undotted ḥā’ - and he is a Successor, well known.

And Surayj ibn al-Nu‘mān, with the undotted sīn and the jīm - one of the shaykhs of al-Bukhārī.

Taḥammul al-Ḥadīth wa-Adā’uhu — Receiving Ḥadīth and Conveying It

Taḥammul al-ḥadīth (receiving ḥadīth): it is transmitting it and taking it from the shaykhs; and upon the more correct position, understanding and discernment are stipulated as being taken into account in that.

Al-Adā’ (conveying): it is relating what one has received. And there is stipulated, in the one by whose transmission argument is made, integrity and precision.

Ṭuruq al-Taḥammul wa-Ṣiyagh al-Adā’ — The Modes of Receiving and the Formulations of Conveying

1 - **Al-Samā’ (direct audition):** from the wording of the shaykh, by dictation from his memory, or by relating from his book; and it is the highest of the modes of receiving.

In conveying, one says: "I heard", or "we heard so-and-so"; then "he related to me", or "he related to us"; then "he informed me", or "he informed us"; then "he announced to me", "he announces to me", "he announced to us", and "we were announced to".

And the first wording is the most explicit in indicating direct audition.

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2 - **Al-Qirā'ah (reading) - to the shaykh** - and some call it *'arḍ* (presentation), because the reader presents to the shaykh what he reads.

This holds whether the student himself read to the shaykh from his memory or from his book, or someone else read to him while he listens; and whether the shaykh had memorised what was read to him, or was holding his original copy, or another trustworthy person was.

In conveying one says: "I read", or "it was read to so-and-so while I was listening." And he may express it with the formulations mentioned before, on condition that he restricts it by mentioning the reading and does not leave it unrestricted - such as: "So-and-so related to me by reading to him."

As to whether presentation is equal to direct audition from the wording of the shaykh, or below it, or above it in rank - there are statements, the most preferred of which is that direct audition is higher.

The basis in this is following the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, for he used to recite the Qur'ān to the people and teach them the Sunnahs.

3 - **Al-Ijāzah (the licence to transmit)**: it is permission for transmission, whether orally or in writing.

And it is of [several] kinds:

a - That he grant a licence to a specified person for a specified thing - and this is the highest of them - such as: "I grant you a licence to transmit from me *Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim*."

b - The licence to a specified person for an unspecified thing, such as: "I grant you a licence to transmit what I have heard."

c - The licence to an unspecified person for a specified thing, such as: "I grant a licence to whoever has lived in my time to transmit *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*."

d - The licence to an unspecified person for an unspecified thing, such as: "I grant a licence to the people of my time to transmit what I have heard."

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e - The licence to a non-existent person following upon an existing one, such as: "I grant a licence to so-and-so and to whoever is born to him after that."

4 - **Al-Munāwalah (handing over)**: and it is of two kinds:

The first: that joined with a licence, and it is the highest of the kinds of licence absolutely.

Its form is that the shaykh hands over to the student his original copy, or a copy collated with it, and says to him: "This is my transmission from so-and-so, so transmit it from me."

And its condition is: that his original remain with the student as a loan, or as a gift, or in ownership, so that he may copy from it.

The second: that stripped of a licence, which is that he hands over to him his original, or what stands in its place, confining himself to his saying: "This is what I heard", or "my transmission from so-and-so."

And it is not taken into consideration in the estimation of the majority.

And the form of conveying by licence or by handing over is: "So-and-so related to me by licence", or "by handing over"; and likewise "he informed me by licence", or "by handing over", or the like of that.

5 - **Al-Mukātabah (correspondence):** it is that the shaykh writes what he has heard for someone present or absent, in his own hand or by his order.

And it too is of two kinds: joined with a licence, and it is in soundness and strength like the joined handing over.

And stripped of a licence, and its ruling is the ruling of the handing over stripped of permission.

And the form of conveying is: "So-and-so related to me by correspondence", or "he wrote to me", or the like of that.

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6 - **Al-I'lām (notification):** it is that the shaykh says that this book is among what I have heard from so-and-so, confining himself to that.

7 - **Al-Waṣiyyah (bequest):** it is that the shaykh bequeaths a book at his death or upon his journey to someone; and it is said in conveying: "So-and-so bequeathed to me", or the like of that.

8 - **Al-Wijādah (the written find):** it is that someone finds a ḥadīth or a book in the hand of a shaykh whom he knows.

He says in conveying: "I found", or "I read in the hand of so-and-so", or the like of that.

And what is transmitted by a written find is of the category of the munqaṭi'.

There is stipulated, for the soundness of transmission by each of notification, bequest, and the written find, that it be joined with a licence, upon the correct position.

[p. 61] Al-Jarḥ wa-l-Ta'dīl — Criticism and Authentication

There is stipulated in the critic and in the authenticator: knowledge, godfearingness, scrupulousness, truthfulness, avoidance of partisanship, and knowledge of the causes of authentication and of criticism - so the two are not accepted except from one who is alert, acquainted with their causes.

And when explained criticism and authentication conflict regarding a single narrator, criticism takes precedence over authentication.

Al-Ḥāfiẓ Ibn Ḥajar said: Their statement that criticism is not accepted unless explained is with regard to one over whose being declared trustworthy or being criticised there is disagreement among the narrators.

But as for one who is unknown, and nothing is known concerning him beyond the statement of a leading authority among the leading authorities of ḥadīth that he is matrūk, or weak, or the like of that - then the statement is his statement, and he is not required to explain that.

Marātib al-Tazkiyah wa-l-Tajrīḥ — The Ranks of Authentication and Criticism

Al-Sakhāwī, in his commentary on the *Alfiyyah*, and Shaykh Akram al-Sindī, in *Im'ān al-Nazar bi-Sharḥ Sharḥ Nukhbat al-Fikar*, made for all of the wordings of criticism and authentication six ranks, which are as follows:

Marātib al-Ta'dīl — The Ranks of Authentication

The first, and it is the highest of them: description with what indicates exaggeration, or expressed with the comparative form - such as: "So-and-so is the most trustworthy of people", or "the most established of people", or "to him precision has come to its end", or "I know no equal to him", or the like of that.

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Then **the second**, such as: "**So-and-so - one does not ask about him.**"

Then **the third, which is: what is emphasised by one of the descriptions indicating authentication** - such as: "trustworthy, trustworthy"; or "established, trustworthy"; or "trustworthy, a proof"; or "trustworthy, precise"; or the like of that.

And the most that has been found of that is the statement of Ibn 'Uyaynah: "‘Amr ibn Dīnār related to us, and he was trustworthy, trustworthy, trustworthy" - until he said it nine times.

Then **the fourth, which is: what is expressed by a formulation indicating authentication without emphasis** - such as: "trustworthy", or "established", or "a proof", or the like.

And "a proof" (*ḥujjah*) is stronger than "established" (*ṭabt*).

Then **the fifth**, such as: "**So-and-so is truthful**", or "**trustworthy [in the sense of reliable]**"; or "**there is no harm in him**", or "**there is no harm in him**" - in the usage of other than Ibn Ma'īn.

Al-Badr ibn Jamā'ah said in his abridgement: Ibn Ma'īn said: When I say of a narrator, "there is no harm in him", or "he is not to be faulted", then he is trustworthy.

And this is a report from him about himself. And the like of it is in the *Muqaddimah* of Ibn al-Ṣalāḥ.

Then **the sixth, which is: what suggests nearness to criticism, and it is the lowest of the ranks**. Such as: "So-and-so is not far from correctness"; or "a shaykh"; or "he is taken into account"; or "a middling shaykh"; or "people transmitted from him"; or "sound in ḥadīth"; or "his ḥadīth is written down"; or "close in ḥadīth"; or "somewhat suitable"; or "truthful, if Allah wills"; or "I hope there is no harm in him"; or the like of that.

Al-Sakhāwī said: Then the ruling regarding the people of these ranks is arguing as proof by the people of the first four of them; but as for those after them, none of their people is argued with as proof - rather his ḥadīth is written down and collated.

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As for the sixth, the ruling regarding its people is below the ruling of the people of the one before it; and some of them write down his ḥadīth for collation without testing their precision, on account of the clarity of their case in that regard.

Marātib al-Jarḥ — The Ranks of Criticism

The first, and it is the worst of them: what indicates exaggeration. Such as: "So-and-so is the most lying of people"; or "to him lying has come to its end"; or "he is the pillar of lying", or "its very mine"; or the like of that.

Then **the second: what is below that, even if it comprises exaggeration.** Such as: "So-and-so is a great impostor"; or "an arch-liar"; or "a fabricator"; and likewise "he fabricates ḥadīth", or "he lies".

Then **the third**, such as: "So-and-so is accused of lying", or "of fabrication"; or "he steals ḥadīth"; or "fallen"; or "matrūk"; or "ruined"; or "gone in ḥadīth"; or "they abandoned him"; or "he is not taken into account"; or "he is not trustworthy"; or the like of that.

Then **the fourth**, such as: "So-and-so - his ḥadīth is rejected"; or "rejected in ḥadīth"; or "very weak"; or "flimsy"; or "they disparaged him at once"; or "they cast him aside"; or "his ḥadīth is not written down"; or "transmission from him is not lawful"; or "he is nothing" - in the usage of other than Ibn Maʿīn.

Al-Sakhāwī said in his commentary on the *Alfiyyah*: Ibn al-Qaṭṭān said: When Ibn Maʿīn says of a narrator "he is nothing", he means that his ḥadīths are few. And the like of it is in the *Muqaddimat al-Fath*.

Then **the fifth**, such as: "So-and-so is not argued with as proof"; or "they declared him weak"; or "shaky in ḥadīth"; or "weak"; or "he has what is disapproved"; or "he has munkar reports"; or "munkar in ḥadīth" - in the usage of other than al-Bukhārī.

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Al-Ḥāfiẓ al-Dhahabī said in *al-Mīzān*, in the biographical notice of Abān ibn Jabalah al-Kūfī and Sulaymān ibn Dāwūd al-Yamāmī: al-Bukhārī said: "Everyone of whom I said 'munkar in ḥadīth' - transmission from him is not lawful."

Then **the sixth, and it is the mildest of them**, such as: "In so-and-so there is something said against him"; or "the least thing said against him"; or "he is disapproved one time and known another"; or "he is not like that"; or "he is not strong"; or "he is not firm"; or "he is not a proof"; or "he is not a mainstay"; or "he is not a ḥāfiẓ"; or "there is something in him"; or "in him is a measure of ignorance"; or "of poor retention"; or "soft in ḥadīth"; or "in him is softness".

And of it is their statement: "So-and-so - they spoke about him"; or "so-and-so - there is a question about him"; or "they kept silent about him" - in the usage of other than al-Bukhārī.

Al-Ḥāfiẓ al-ʿIrāqī said in the commentary on his *Alfiyyah*: "So-and-so - there is a question about him", and "so-and-so - they kept silent about him": these are two expressions which al-Bukhārī uses of those whose ḥadīth they abandoned.

Al-Sakhāwī said in his commentary on the *Alfiyyah*: Then the ruling regarding the people of these ranks is that none of the people of the first four of them is argued with as proof, nor is his transmission taken as a supporting narration, nor is it collated.

And everyone mentioned in the fifth and the sixth - his ḥadīth is collated; that is, it is brought out for collation.

[p. 65] Asʿilah wa-Tamārīn — Questions and Exercises

1. What are the kinds of the report with respect to the end-point of its isnād? And how many kinds does

the marfū‘ have? Explain them with examples.

And who is the Companion, and by what is Companionship known? And who is the Successor, and who are the mukhaḍrams, and are they of the Companions or of the Successors?

2. What are the elevated and the descending, and what are the kinds of each of them?

And what are concurrence, substitution, parity, and the handshake?

3. Define the peers, the mudabbaj, the transmission of seniors from juniors and the reverse of that, the earlier and the later, and the undifferentiated; then mention what you know of the benefits of these kinds.
4. What is the ruling regarding the narrator whose transmission from him the shaykh has denied? And is the shaykh's denial an impugning of his integrity, or of the integrity of the narrator transmitting from him?

And what is the chained ḥadīth, and what is the benefit of chaining? And what is the agreeing-and-differing, and the concordant-and-discordant among names? And what is the benefit of each kind?

5. What is meant by receiving ḥadīth and conveying it, and what is stipulated in each?

Mention some of the modes of receiving and the formulations used in conveying, explaining the ruling of transmission by each of notification, bequest, and the written find.

6. And what is stipulated in each of the critic and the authenticator, and what is the ruling of criticism and authentication when the two conflict?

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7. Mention the ranks of criticism and authentication, making clear the ruling regarding the people of these ranks; then explain what is meant by their statement: "there is no harm in him", and "he is nothing", in the usage of Ibn Ma‘īn; and what is meant by their statement: "there is a question about him", and "they kept silent about him", in the usage of al-Bukhārī.

[p. 67] Ma‘rifat al-Asmā’ wa-l-Kunā wa-l-Ansāb wa-l-Alqāb wa-l-Mawālī — Knowledge of Names, Kunyahs, Lineages, Titles, and Clients

Among what there is pressing need for is knowing the names of those narrators who have *kunyahs*, and knowing the *kunyahs* of those of them who have names - because the narrator may be mentioned by his name at one time, and by his *kunyah* at another, so that whoever has no knowledge of that supposes him to be two persons, whereas he is one.

And it is of [several] kinds:

1 - **He who became well known by his name rather than his *kunyah*, or the reverse of that** - such as: Ṭalḥah ibn ‘Ubayd Allāh, and ‘Abd al-Raḥmān ibn ‘Awf, and al-Ḥasan ibn ‘Alī; for the *kunyah* of each of them is: Abū Muḥammad.

And such as: Abū Idrīs al-Khawlānī - his name is ‘Ā‘idh Allāh; and Abū Ishāq al-Sabī‘ī - his name is ‘Amr.

2 - **He whose name is his *kunya*** - such as: Abū Bilāl al-Ash‘arī, [transmitting] from Sharīk; and Abū Ḥaṣīn, with a fatḥah on the undotted ḥā’, [transmitting] from Abū Ḥātim al-Rāzī. Each of the two said: "My name is my *kunya*."

3 - **He over whose name there is disagreement** - such as: Abū Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him. There is disagreement over his name and his father's name, upon about thirty statements, the most well known of which is: ‘Abd al-Raḥmān ibn Ṣakhr.

4 - **He over whose *kunya* there is disagreement** - such as: Usāmah ibn Zayd; it was said his *kunya* is Abū Khārijah, or Abū Muḥammad, or Abū ‘Abd Allāh - [these are] statements.

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5 - **He whose *kunyahs* are many** - such as: Ibn Jurayj; he has two *kunyahs*: Abū Khālid and Abū al-Walīd.

6 - **He whose *kunya* agrees with his father's name, or the reverse of that** - such as: Abū Muslim al-Aghar ibn Muslim al-Madanī, the narrator from Abū Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him; and Abū Ishāq al-Ṭālaqānī ibn Ishāq. And such as: Ishāq ibn Abī Ishāq al-Sabīṭ.

7 - **He whose father's name agrees with the name of his shaykh** - such as: al-Rabī‘ ibn Anas, [transmitting] from Anas, may Allah be pleased with him; for his father is Bakrī, and his shaykh is Anas ibn Mālik, the servant of the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him.

8 - **He whose name agrees, as the narrator, with the name of his shaykh** - such as Imam al-Bukhārī: Muslim, the author of the *Ṣaḥīḥ*, transmits from him; and al-Bukhārī transmitted from Muslim ibn Ibrāhīm al-Farāhīdī al-Azdī.

So one who does not know that may suppose, when he hears: "Muslim related to us, from al-Bukhārī, from Muslim", that this is an inverted isnād, or that in it there is repetition - whereas it is not so.

9 - **He whose name agrees with the name of his shaykh and the shaykh of his shaykh** - such as: ‘Imrān, from ‘Imrān, from ‘Imrān. The first is ‘Imrān al-Qaṣīr, the second Abū Rajā’ al-‘Uṭāridī, and the third Ibn Ḥuṣayn, the well-known Companion.

10 - **He whose name agrees with his father's name and his grandfather's name** - such as: al-Ḥasan ibn al-Ḥasan ibn al-Ḥasan ibn ‘Alī ibn Abī Ṭālib, may Allah be pleased with him.

11 - **He whose *kunya* agrees with the *kunya* of his wife** - such as: Abū Ayyūb and Umm Ayyūb, the two Companions.

And likewise it is important to know the names stripped of *kunyahs*, and the *kunyahs*

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stripped of names, and to know the singular ones among names, *kunyahs*, and titles - which are those by which none has been named except one person.

Among the singular names are: Aḥmad ibn ‘Ajyān; and Sandar, with the fatḥah, the client of Zinbā’ al-Judhāmī.

And among the singular *kunyahs*: Abū al-‘Usharā’ - his name is Usāmah; and Abū al-‘Ubaydayn, in the dual and diminutive form - his name is Mu‘āwīyah ibn Sabrah, one of the companions of Ibn Mas‘ūd, may Allah be pleased with him.

And among the singular titles: *Safīnah*, the client of the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him - his name is 'Umayr, or Mihrān, or Ṣāliḥ; and it is said other than that.

And Saḥnūn: 'Abd al-Salām ibn Sa'īd al-Qayrawānī.

And like names and *kunyahs* in the attention due to them is the knowledge of titles and lineages.

And the title (*laqab*) may be in the form of a name, such as: *Safīnah*, the servant of the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him. And it may be in the form of a *kunyah*, such as: Abū Turāb, the title of 'Alī ibn Abī Ṭālib, may Allah be pleased with him.

And it may be that his relation is to a defect, or a craft, or a trade - such as: al-A'raj (the lame), al-Khayyāṭ (the tailor), and al-Bazzāz (the cloth-merchant).

And the relative attribution (*nisbah*) falls at one time to the tribe - and they are the sons of one father - such as: al-Qurashī and al-Dawsī.

And at another time to the homeland, which is the place of a person's residence, whether a town, or a village - which is the farmstead - or a quarter, which is the district. Such as: al-Baghdādī, al-Ḍay'ī, al-Qaṭī'ī, and al-Dāraqūṭnī; and Qaṭī'at Daqīq and Dār al-Quṭn are two districts in Baghdad.

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And the relative attribution may be to other than the father - such as: al-Miqdād ibn al-Aswad; he was attributed to al-Aswad ibn 'Abd Yaghūth al-Zuhrī, for he was in his care and he adopted him; whereas he is only al-Miqdād ibn 'Amr ibn Tha'labah al-Kindī.

And the relative attribution may be to the mother - such as: Bilāl ibn Ḥamāmah, and his father is Rabāḥ; and Ismā'īl ibn 'Ulayyah, and his father is Ibrāhīm ibn Miqsam al-Asadī by clientage.

And the relative attribution may be to other than what first comes to mind - such as: Khālīd al-Ḥadhdhā' (the cobbler); he used to sit with the cobblers.

And lineages may fall out as titles - such as: Khālīd ibn Makhlad al-Qaṭawānī al-Kūfī; he was so titled in relation to *Qaṭawān*, and he was tall of leg with a short stride.

And it is likewise important to know the causes of titles and lineages, since they may sometimes be contrary to what is outwardly apparent - such as: Mu'āwiyah ibn 'Abd al-Karīm *al-Ḍāll* (the one who lost his way); he lost his way on the road to Makkah al-Mukarramah. And 'Abd Allāh ibn Muḥammad *al-Ḍa'if* (the weak); [so called] on account of weakness in his body.

Al-Ḥāfiẓ 'Abd al-Ghanī ibn Sa'īd al-Azdī said: Two eminent men to whom two ugly titles clung.

And the like of it: al-Ḥasan ibn Yazīd *al-Qawī* (the strong), on account of his strength in worship.

And Abū Mas'ūd 'Uqbah ibn 'Amr *al-Badrī*; he did not witness Badr, but he only dwelt there, so he was attributed to it, upon the more correct position.

And of what is connected with what has preceded is the knowledge of the clients (*al-mawālī*) among the scholars and the narrators, and the knowledge of the brothers and sisters among them.

[p. 71] Anwā' al-Walā' — The Kinds of Clientage

Clientage is of three kinds:

1 - **Walā' al-ʿitāqah (clientage by manumission)**: and it is the most common; and many of the narrators are attributed to a tribe that manumitted them - such as: al-Layth ibn Sa'd al-Miṣrī al-Fahmī, the client of Fahm.

2 - **Walā' bi-l-Islām (clientage by Islam)**: and it is that if a man accepts Islam at the hand of another man, he is attributed to his tribe - such as: Muḥammad ibn Ismā'īl al-Bukhārī al-Ju'fī; his grandfather al-Mughīrah accepted Islam at the hand of al-Yamān ibn Akhnas al-Ju'fī, so he was attributed to him.

3 - **Walā' bi-l-ḥilf (clientage by alliance)**, with the kasrah, from *al-muḥālafah*, which is contracting mutual support and mutual assistance - such as: Imam Mālik ibn Anas al-Aṣḥabī al-Taymī by clientage; for his kin became clients of the Taym of Quraysh by alliance.

And it is said that his grandfather Mālik ibn Abī 'Āmir was a hired man for Ṭalḥah ibn 'Ubayd Allāh al-Taymī.

This being so, the wording *al-mawlā* is shared between: the upper client - and he is the manumitter, with the kasrah, and the ally, with the faṭḥah, and the one at whose hands another accepted Islam; and the lower client - and he is the manumitted one, and the ally, with the kasrah, and the one who accepted Islam at the hand of another.

And among the benefits of knowing the clients among the narrators, and knowing the brothers and sisters among them, is safety from confusion, and security against supposing a multiplicity to be one, or supposing one who is not a brother to be a brother on account of sharing in the father's name - such as: 'Abd Allāh ibn Dīnār and 'Amr ibn Dīnār; both of them are of a single generation, and they are not two brothers.

[p. 72] Kitābat al-Ḥadīth wa-'Arḍuhu wa-Ismā'uhu wa-l-Riḥlah fī Ṭalabihi — The Writing of Ḥadīth, Its Collation, Its Being Made Heard, and the Journey in Seeking It

Kitābat al-Ḥadīth — The Writing of Ḥadīth

It is that it be in a clear, plain hand; that what is problematic in it be vowelled and dotted; and that what has been dropped be written on the right-hand margin, if that is possible, and otherwise on the left.

Samā' al-Ḥadīth — The Hearing of Ḥadīth

It is receiving it and taking it from the shaykhs. **And its condition is:** that the student be alert at the time of hearing, from the wording of the shaykh or from the reading to him; and that he not occupy himself with what would impair it, of speech, or reading, or writing something other than what is being heard.

'Arḍ al-Ḥadīth — The Collation of Ḥadīth

It is that the student collate [his copy] with the shaykh - whether the shaykh has his original with him, or relies upon his memory; or that he collate it with another trustworthy person; or that he collate it himself against the shaykh's original, or against a copy collated with it.

Ismā' al-Ḥadīth — Making Ḥadīth Heard

It is relating it. **And its condition is:** that the shaykh be alert at the time of making it heard and relating it, unoccupied with what would impair it; and that his conveying be from his original in which he heard it, or from a copy collated with it - and if that is not feasible, then let him make up for it with a licence.

[p. 73] Al-Riḥlah fī Ṭalab al-Ḥadīth — The Journey in Seeking Ḥadīth

It is leaving one's homeland in order to acquire what the narrator does not have of the matns and the isnāds, after he has comprehended the ḥadīth of the people of his own town.

And let his concern for increasing the matns be greater than his interest in increasing the isnāds.

Al-Taṣnīf fī al-Ḥadīth — Composition in Ḥadīth

It is obligatory upon whoever finds in himself the capacity for composition in ḥadīth to occupy himself with that, in order to gather what is scattered, to bring near what is remote, to clarify what is problematic, and to explain what is stated summarily.

And that he not let his composition leave his hand except after refining it and repeatedly looking into it. And let his authorship be in what the need for it is general and the benefit from it abundant.

Anwā' al-Taṣnīf — The Kinds of Composition

1 - Al-Jawāmi' (the comprehensive collections)

Al-Jāmi' is every book that gathers the ḥadīths of creeds, legal rulings, heart-softening exhortations, the etiquette of eating and drinking, travel, standing and sitting, Qur'ānic exegesis, the campaign-histories and biography, history, the trials, virtues and faults - such as *al-Jāmi' al-Ṣaḥīḥ* of Imam al-Bukhārī.

2 - Al-Masānīd (the musnad collections)

Al-Musnad is every book in which the transmissions of each Companion are gathered separately, without

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being restricted to the authenticity of the ḥadīth or its ḥasan character, and without regard to the suitability of a chapter or the like - such as the *Musnad* of Imam Aḥmad ibn Ḥanbal.

3 - Al-Ma'ājim (the lexicon-style collections)

Al-Mu'jam is every book in which the ḥadīths are mentioned according to the arrangement of the shaykhs; and most commonly the arrangement in it is by the letters of the alphabet - such as the three *Mu'jams* of al-Ṭabarānī.

4 - Al-'Ilal (the works on hidden defects)

These are the books that gather the defective ḥadīths, with an explanation of their hidden defects. Among those who composed in this kind are: Imam Aḥmad, and al-Dāraquṭnī, and Ibn Abī Ḥātim.

5 - Al-Ajzā' (the fascicles)

Al-Juz' is that in which the ḥadīths of a single man are gathered - whether he be one of the Companions or of those after them; or that in which the ḥadīths relating to a single topic are mentioned - such as the fascicle on raising the hands in prayer, and the fascicle on reciting behind the imam, both of them by Imam al-Bukhārī.

6 - Al-Aṭrāf (the works on ḥadīth-openings)

It says in the *Tadrīb*: Composition by *aṭrāf* is: that the opening phrase of the ḥadīth, which indicates the remainder of it, be mentioned, and its isnāds gathered - either exhaustively, or restricted to particular books - such as *Tuhfat al-Ashrāf bi-Ma'rifat al-Aṭrāf* [The Gift to the Noble in the Knowledge of Ḥadīth-Openings] by al-Ḥāfiẓ Abū al-Ḥajjāj al-Mizzī.

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7 - Al-Mustadrakāt (the supplements)

Al-Mustadrak is every book in which what the author of another book missed, according to his own condition, is supplied - such as the *Mustadrak* of Abū 'Abd Allāh al-Ḥākim.

8 - Al-Mustakhrajāt (the re-derived collections)

Al-Mustakhraj is every book in which the ḥadīths of another book are brought out with authentic isnāds by other than the route of the author of that book, meeting up with him at his shaykh or at someone above him among the men - such as the *Mustakhraj* of Abū Nu'aym al-Aṣḥabānī upon the two *Ṣaḥīḥs*.

This being so, the compilers of the *mustakhrajs* most often did not bind themselves, in the matn of the ḥadīth, to the wording of the book upon which it was re-derived; rather they transmitted it with the wordings that came to them from their shaykhs, together with divergence from the wordings of the book re-derived upon.

For this reason it is not permissible to ascribe the wordings of a ḥadīth found in a *mustakhraj* to the book upon which it was re-derived, unless their agreement in wording is known.

Ādāb al-Shaykh wa-l-Ṭālib — The Etiquette of the Teacher and the Student

And of what there is pressing need for is knowing the etiquette of the teacher and the student.

The two share in correcting the intention, purifying the heart from worldly aims, acting upon knowledge, and giving sincere counsel to the Muslims.

The teacher is distinguished by this: that when he attends the session of ḥadīth transmission he should turn towards those present, open his session and close it with the praise of Allah and prayers and peace upon the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him. And if anyone raises his voice, he should order him to lower it - because

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raising the voice at the mention of his ḥadīth, peace and blessings be upon him, is like raising it in his presence; and Allah has forbidden that.

And that no one should rise for anyone during the transmission; and that he not relate standing, nor in haste, nor on the road, except for a need.

And he should refrain from transmitting if he fears forgetfulness or confusion through decrepitude, or dotage, or blindness, or the like of that.

And the student is distinguished by this: that he honour his shaykh and hold him in esteem, for that is part of revering knowledge and among the causes of benefiting from it.

And that neither pride nor bashfulness prevent him from complete striving in acquiring and taking knowledge, even from one who is below him in age, or in standing, or in lineage.

And that he be patient with the shaykh's harshness; and that he give care to precision and to committing to writing, and review what he has memorised, and discuss with the people of knowledge, so that it may take firm root in his mind.

Ibn Mas'ūd, may Allah be pleased with him, said: Discuss ḥadīth with one another, for discussing it is its life.

And from Ibn 'Abbās, may Allah be pleased with him: Discussing knowledge for an hour is better than spending a night in worship.

And from al-Zuhrī: The blight of knowledge is forgetfulness and little discussion.

And that his memorisation of ḥadīth be by degrees, little by little; for in the *Ṣaḥīḥ*: "Take on of deeds what you are able for."

And that he act upon what he hears of the ḥadīths of the acts of worship and of etiquette, for that is the zakāt of ḥadīth and the cause of its being retained.

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Wakī' said: If you want to memorise ḥadīth, then act upon it.

And Imam Aḥmad, may Allah have mercy on him, said: I did not write down a ḥadīth but that I acted upon it - until there passed by me that the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, was cupped and gave Abū Ṭaybah a dīnār; so I was cupped and gave the cupper a dīnār.

And that he not confine himself to hearing ḥadīth and writing it without knowing it and understanding it; and that he give precedence to the two *Ṣaḥīḥs*, then the *Sunan* of Abū Dāwūd, al-Tirmidhī, al-Nasā'ī and Ibn Mājah, and the *Ṣaḥīḥs* of Ibn Khuzaymah and Ibn Ḥibbān, then *al-Sunan al-Kubrā* of al-Bayhaqī.

Then what there is pressing need for of the *musnad* collections, such as the *Musnad* of Aḥmad, and the comprehensive collections, and the rest of the compilations in ḥadīth.

Then, of the works on hidden defects, such as the book of Imam Aḥmad, and al-Dāraqutnī, and Ibn Abī Ḥātim; and of names, such as *al-Tārīkh al-Kabīr* of al-Bukhārī and the *Tārīkh* of Ibn Abī Khaythamah.

And of the precise recording of names, such as *al-Ikmāl* of Ibn Mākūlā. And of unfamiliar wordings, such as *al-Nihāyah* of Ibn al-Athīr. And let exactitude be his concern.

[p. 78] Khātimah fī anna al-Sunnah Ḥujjah ‘alā Jamī‘ al-Ummah — Conclusion: That the Sunnah Is a Proof Against the Whole Community

Allah the Exalted said: "And whatever the Messenger gives you, take it; and whatever he forbids you, abstain from it." (Sūrat al-Ḥashr 59:7)

And He said: "Say: If you love Allah, then follow me; Allah will love you and forgive you your sins." (Sūrat Āl ‘Imrān 3:31)

And He said: "Certainly you have in the Messenger of Allah an excellent example for whoever hopes in Allah and the Last Day." (Sūrat al-Aḥzāb 33:21)

And He said: "But no, by your Lord, they do not believe until they make you judge concerning what is in dispute between them, and then find in themselves no discomfort from what you have decided, and submit in full submission." (Sūrat al-Nisā’ 4:65)

And He said: "And if you dispute over anything, refer it to Allah and the Messenger, if you believe in Allah and the Last Day." (Sūrat al-Nisā’ 4:59)

And He, glorified be He, said: "So let those who oppose his command beware, lest a trial befall them or a painful punishment befall them." (Sūrat al-Nūr 24:63)

And the verses on that are many.

And the Sunnah of the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, is, in the estimation of the four leading authorities and the rest of the godly scholars, more venerable and more mighty than that the statement of anyone whosoever should be given precedence over it.

And part of the whole of venerating the Sunnah and honouring it is acting by it.

Ibn ‘Ābidīn said in his commentary on the poem entitled *‘Uqūd Rasm al-Muftī* [The Strands of the Muftī's Method]: It has been established authentically from Abū Ḥanīfah, may Allah's mercy be upon him, that he said: "When the ḥadīth is authentic, then it is my school."

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Imam Ibn ‘Abd al-Barr mentioned that from Imam Abū Ḥanīfah and others of the leading authorities.

And from Imam Mālik, may Allah have mercy on him, that he said: "There is no one but that some of his speech is taken and some rejected, except the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him."

And from Imam al-Shāfi‘ī, may Allah be pleased with him: "When the ḥadīth is authentic, then it is my school."

And he said: "If you see my statement contradicting the ḥadīth, then act by the ḥadīth and cast my statement against the wall."

And he said: "The Muslims have reached consensus that whoever has a Sunnah of the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, made clear to him, it is not lawful for him to abandon it for the statement of anyone."

And from Imam Aḥmad ibn Ḥanbal, that he said to some of his companions: "Do not follow me blindly, and do not blindly follow Mālik, nor al-Awzā'ī, nor al-Nakha'ī, nor anyone else; and take the rulings from where they took them: from the Book and the Sunnah."

And Imam Walī Allāh al-Dihlawī said in *Ḥujjat Allāh al-Bālighah*: The people were not agreed upon pure blind following of the school of a particular leading authority, nor upon deriving jurisprudence for him or reporting his statement, up to the fourth century of the Hijrah, as that appears from tracing it through. Then, after these excellent generations, there came people who went right and left, and blind following crept into their breasts with the creeping of ants, while they did not perceive it.

And he said, quoting from Shaykh 'Izz al-Dīn ibn 'Abd al-Salām: And the astonishing thing is that the blindly-following jurists - one of them comes to know the weakness of his leading authority's basis of derivation, such that he finds no way to repel it; and along with that he blindly follows him in it, and abandons the one for whom the Book and the Sunnah and the sound analogies bear witness, out of rigid adherence to their school; rather he contrives

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to repel the outward senses of the Book and the Sunnah, and interprets them with false interpretations, in defence of the one he blindly follows.

And al-'Izz said: The people did not cease asking whoever among the scholars was available to them, without specifying a school and without any denunciation of any of those asking - until these schools appeared and their partisans among the blind followers appeared. For one of them follows his leading authority after having become distant from the proofs, blindly following him in what he said, as though he were a prophet who had been sent. And this is a swerving from the truth and a distance from correctness, which no one of sound intellect is pleased with.

And Imam Ibn al-Qayyim said in *I'lām al-Muwaqqi'in*: We see many of the people, when a ḥadīth comes agreeing with the statement of the one they blindly follow, while its own narrator contradicted it, saying: "The proof is in what he transmitted, not in what he held as opinion."

But when the statement of the narrator comes agreeing with the statement of the one they blindly follow, while the ḥadīth contradicts him, he says: "The narrator would not contradict what he transmitted unless its abrogation had been established in his estimation; otherwise that would be an impugning of his integrity."

So they combine in their speech between this and that; rather, we have seen that within a single chapter - and this is among the ugliest of self-contradiction.

And that which we hold as religion before Allah, and which nothing else suffices us in, is: that the ḥadīth, when it is authentic from the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, without any opposing evidence or abrogation, then the obligation upon us and upon the whole community is to take by the ḥadīth and to abandon what contradicts it.

And we do not abandon the ḥadīth on account of the disagreement of anyone of the people, whosoever he be - neither its narrator nor anyone else; since it is possible that the narrator forget the ḥadīth, or that it not come to his mind at the time of giving the legal opinion, or that he not be alert to its indication upon that question, or that he interpret it with a less-preferred interpretation, or that there be in his estimation something he supposes to be opposing it while it is not in fact opposing, or that he blindly follow

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someone other than him in his legal opinion, out of his belief that he is more knowledgeable than himself, and that he would not have contradicted except for what is stronger than it.

And even if the absence of all that were supposed, there is no way to knowing its absence, nor to supposing it - and the narrator is not infallible.

And in *Qāmūs al-Sharī'ah* by al-Sa'dī: When the Companion raises a report to the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, acting by it becomes obligatory upon whomever it reaches of those legally responsible, until he meets with another report that abrogates it; and at that point it is incumbent upon the one who acted by the first report to return to the second and to abandon acting by the first.

And Shaykh Šāliḥ al-Fullānī al-Madanī said in his book *Īqāz al-Himam* [The Rousing of Aspirations]: You see some of the people, when they find a ḥadīth agreeing with their school, rejoicing at it and submitting to it.

And if he finds an authentic ḥadīth, free of any opposing evidence and of abrogation, supporting a school other than that of his leading authority, he opens for it the door of far-fetched possibilities and turns away from it, dismissing it and obstructing it; and he seeks out for the school of his leading authority modes of preference, along with its contradicting the Companions and the Successors and the explicit text.

And if he comments on a book among the books of ḥadīth, he alters every ḥadīth that contradicted his school; and if he is unable to do that, he claims abrogation without proof, or particularity [to the Prophet], or that it is not acted upon, or other than that of what comes to the mind of the sick at heart.

And if he is unable to do that, he claims that his leading authority was acquainted with everything transmitted, or with most of it, and that he did not abandon this noble ḥadīth except having become acquainted with something that impugns it - by his own opinion,

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the sublime. So he takes the scholars of his school as lords, and opens for their virtues and their marvels doors, and believes that whoever contradicts that has not been granted correctness.

And if one of the scholars of the Sunnah counsels him, he takes him as an enemy, even if they had before that been beloved friends.

And if he finds a book among the books of his well-known school containing counsel to him, and censure of opinion and blind following, and exhortation to follow the ḥadīths - he casts it behind his back, and turns away from its command and its prohibition, and takes it as something abandoned and shut away.

And al-Fullānī said, quoting from his shaykh Muḥammad Ḥayāt al-Sindī, may Allah the Exalted have mercy on him: It has been established that the Companions were not all of them capable of independent legal reasoning (*ijtihād*) according to the technical usage of the scholars; for among them were the villager and the bedouin, and one who heard from him, peace and blessings be upon him, a single ḥadīth, or accompanied him a single time.

And there is no doubt that whoever heard a ḥadīth from the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, or from one of the Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, used to act by it according to his understanding of it - whether he was capable of independent reasoning or not; and it is not known that the one among them who was not capable of independent reasoning was charged with returning to the one who was, regarding what he had heard of the ḥadīths - neither in his time, peace and blessings be upon him,

nor after him in the time of the Companions, may Allah's good pleasure be upon them.

So this is a tacit approval from him, peace and blessings be upon him, of the permissibility of acting by ḥadīth for one who is not capable of independent reasoning, and a consensus of the Companions upon that.

And were it not so, the caliphs would have ordered those of them not capable of independent reasoning, such as the people of the deserts, not to

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act by what reached them from the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, whether directly from his mouth or through an intermediary, until they had presented it to those of them capable of independent reasoning.

And of this there has come neither trace nor track.

And this is the outward sense of the statement of Allah the Exalted: "And whatever the Messenger gives you, take it; and whatever he forbids you, abstain from it." (Sūrat al-Ḥashr 59:7)

And he said in *al-Īqāz*: The shaykh of our shaykhs, the exacting scholar Abū al-Ḥasan al-Sindī, said in his marginal notes upon *Fath al-Qadīr*: It is not incumbent, in the case of the ordinary person, to take a particular school, on account of his not being guided to what is more fitting and more proper; rather the obligation in his case is to take by the statement of every scholar who is trusted in the religion, on account of the statement of Allah the Exalted: "So ask the people of remembrance if you do not know." (Sūrat al-Naḥl 16:43)

And he said in *al-Baḥr al-Rā'iq*: It is permissible to follow blindly whichever of those capable of independent reasoning one wishes; and even if the schools have been written down, as today, he may transfer from his school.

Shaykh Muḥammad Ḥayāt al-Sindī said: And this which he has mentioned is that upon which the Book and the Sunnah and the statements of the excellent scholars, of the earlier and the later generations, indicate. And no consideration is given to the statement of one who says other than that; for every statement that contradicts the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, and the statements of the scholars who are the foremost of the religion, is rejected upon the one who says it.

And I do not think him to be other than devoid of knowledge and abundant in partisanship. And Allah is the granter of success to what He loves and is pleased with.

And no one has any say alongside the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him - whosoever he be, and whatever he be, and from whomever he be.

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And when the river of Allah comes, the river of Ma'qil is voided.

With that, what we intended to gather is complete; and in closing we say:

"O Allah, show us the truth as truth and grant us the following of it; and show us falsehood as falsehood and grant us the shunning of it.

And send prayers, O Allah, upon Your servant and Your Messenger Muḥammad, and upon his family and his Companions, and grant them abundant peace."

‘Abd al-Karīm Murād and ‘Abd al-Muḥsin al-‘Abbād

15 - 4 - 1386 AH
Madinah al-Munawwarah

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[p. 90] (blank)

Notes

1. [p. 7] The book gives *al-sanad* and *al-isnād* as two separate headwords and then says the second sense of *al-isnād* is synonymous with *al-sanad*.
The fixed glossary maps سند to "isnād", which collapses the distinction the page is making.
The two headwords are kept transliterated distinctly (**al-Sanad** / **al-Isnād**) in that one passage; **isnād** is used everywhere else in running text.
2. [p. 4, p. 75] مستخرج is rendered "*mustakhraj*" rather than translated, since it is itself a technical term of the discipline (defined by the authors on p. 75).
Likewise *mustadrak*, *mu'jam*, *juz'*, *aṭrāf*.
3. [p. 5] The printed title is نخبة الفكر في مصطلح الاثر, without the word أهل that the commonly circulated title (*Nukhbat al-Fikar fī Muṣṭalaḥ Ahl al-Athar*) carries.
Translated exactly as printed.
4. [p. 5] الطوفى: pointed as printed without full vocalisation; read here as **al-Ṭūfī**.
Given the death date 883 AH this is not the well-known Najm al-Dīn al-Ṭūfī (d. 716 AH), and the identification could not be verified from the page itself.
5. [p. 5] The son of Ibn Ḥajar is printed as محمد بن أحمد بن حجر; retained as printed without emendation.
6. [p. 6] مطلق وقيل بينهما عموم وخصوص مطلق is rendered "absolute generality and particularity" - the logicians' term for the relation in which one category wholly contains the other.
Preserved as one of three reported opinions, with no preference expressed.
7. [pp. 9, 27, 34, etc.] Ḥadīth citations are given exactly as the authors print them, including where a matn is cut off with الحديث ("the ḥadīth"), the standard signal that the remainder is omitted.

No gradings have been added or changed.

8. **[p. 14]** The authors give one definition of *al-shādhah* here and note "it has another interpretation which will come later"; the second interpretation appears on p. 19 (the trustworthy narrator's addition) and a third on p. 44 (the report of one whose poor retention is innate). All three are preserved as printed, without harmonisation.
9. **[p. 41]** The distinction between *al-muṣaḥḥaf* (alteration of the pointing/dotting) and *al-muḥarraf* (alteration of the vowelling) is the authors' own; both are rendered with fixed English glosses ("misread" / "miswritten") to keep them distinct in English.
10. **[p. 53]** The chronology as printed - Mālik's death given as 124 and al-Zuhrī as the transmitter from him - reverses the conventional dates (al-Zuhrī d. 124, Mālik d. 179). The sentence has been translated exactly as printed rather than emended; the distance of 135 years given at the end of the passage is likewise as printed.
11. **[p. 62, p. 63]** ثقة is rendered "trustworthy" per the fixed glossary; where the sixth rank of authentication uses مأمون in a near-synonymous sense, it is rendered "trustworthy [in the sense of reliable]" to keep the fixed rendering of ثقة unambiguous.
12. **[p. 72]** عرض الحديث is rendered "collation" here, matching the fixed rendering of اعتبار as "collation" only in the ordinary English sense; the two are distinguished in context, and عرض in the sense of "presentation" (reading to the shaykh) on p. 58 is rendered "presentation". This is the one place where a different rendering is defensible - "checking" or "comparison" would also serve for عرض on p. 72.
13. **[p. 78, p. 83]** Qur'ānic references (sūrah and verse numbers) have been supplied in parentheses; the printed text gives only the verses themselves without citation.
14. **[pp. 85-89]** The index is set as a table for legibility; the printed original is a dotted-leader list with Arabic-Indic page numbers, converted here.
15. No word anywhere in the book was illegible in the scan.

Glossary additions

Arabic	Rendering used
مصطلح الحديث	muṣṭalaḥ al-ḥadīth / the terminology of ḥadīth
محدث	ḥadīth scholar (muḥaddith)
حافظ	ḥāfiẓ
مسند (faṭḥ al-nūn)	musnad
مسند (kasr al-nūn)	musnid
مستخرج	mustakhraj
مستدرک	mustadrak (supplement)
معجم	mu'jam
جزء / أجزاء	fascicle (juz')

أطراف	aṭrāf (ḥadīth-openings)
علل	‘ilal (hidden defects)
تقرير	tacit approval
وصف خُلقي / خُلقي	physical description / description of character
متواتر لفظي / معنوي	verbal (<i>lafẓī</i>) / by-meaning (<i>ma‘nawī</i>) mutawātir
تواتر	successive following-on (<i>tawātur</i>)
مستفيض	mustafīḍ
فرد مطلق / نسبي	absolutely / relatively solitary (<i>al-fard</i>)
محفوظ	maḥfūẓ
معروف	ma‘rūf
متابعة تامة / قاصرة	complete / deficient corroborating chain
متابع	corroborating narration (<i>mutābi‘</i>)
محكم	muḥkam
مختلف الحديث	conflicting ḥadīth
نسخ	abrogation (<i>naskh</i>)
مروءة	personal propriety (<i>murū‘ah</i>)
ضبط صدر / كتاب	precision of the breast / of the book
مستور	<i>mastūr</i> (the outwardly upright but inwardly unexamined narrator)
مجهول العين / الحال	unknown in person / unknown in condition
مبهم	unnamed narrator (<i>mubham</i>)
مهمل	undifferentiated (<i>muhmal</i>)
مختلط	<i>mukhtaliṭ</i> (whose memory became confused)
بدعة مكفرة / مفسقة	innovation amounting to disbelief / to open sinfulness
تدليس الإسناد / الشيوخ / التسوية	tadlīs of the chain / of the shaykhs / of levelling
مرسل خفي	hidden mursal
إرسال	sending (<i>irsāl</i>)
تعليق	suspension (<i>ta‘līq</i>)
وجادة	written find (<i>wijādah</i>)

مناولة	handing over (<i>munāwalah</i>)
مكاتبة	correspondence (<i>mukātabah</i>)
إعلام	notification (<i>i'lām</i>)
وصية	bequest (<i>waṣiyyah</i>)
قراءة / عرض	reading / presentation
أداء	conveying (<i>adā`</i>)
تحمل	receiving (<i>taḥammul</i>)
علو / نزول	elevation / descent
موافقة / بدل / مساواة / مصافحة	concurrence / substitution / parity / handshake
أقران / مدبج	peers / <i>mudabbaj</i>
سابق ولاحق	the earlier and the later
مسلسل	chained (<i>musalsal</i>)
متفق ومفترق	agreeing-and-differing
مؤتلف ومختلف	concordant-and-discordant
متشابه	resembling (<i>mutashābih</i>)
كنية	<i>kunyah</i>
لقب / نسبة	title / relative attribution (<i>nisbah</i>)
موالي / ولاء	clients / clientage (<i>walā`</i>)
مخضرم	<i>mukhaḍram</i>
محرّف	miswritten (<i>muḥarraf</i>)
مزيد في متصل الأسانيد	the addition in connected isnāds
اجتهاد / مجتهد	independent legal reasoning / one capable of it
تقليد / مقلّد	blind following / blind follower
رحلة	the journey [in seeking ḥadīth]
تصنيف	composition
جامع	comprehensive collection (<i>jāmi`</i>)
ثبت / حجة	established (<i>thabt</i>) / a proof (<i>ḥujjah</i>)
تزكية / تجريح	authentication / criticism